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Software pipeline and release validation

Abstract

The present disclosure provides systems, methods, and computer readable storage devices for validating that a software release has successfully completed multiple development stages of a development process without alteration. To illustrate, as software (e.g., one or more files or artifacts) completes at least a portion of a development process including the development stages, data components are generated. Digital signatures are generated based on the data components and a private key, and the digital signatures are stored in a secure data structure, such as a blockchain or a tree structure. Upon receipt of the data components (e.g., as validation data of a software release) by a node device, the node device generates validation signatures based on the data components and a public key and compares the validation signatures to the digital signatures stored in the secure data structure to validate the software before processing the software.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a divisional of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/221,027, filed Apr. 2, 2021, and entitled “SOFTWARE PIPELINE AND RELEASE VALIDATION”; which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/117,723, filed Nov. 24, 2020 entitled “SOFTWARE RELEASE VALIDATION”, the contents of which are incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present application is generally related to the technical field of software deployment, and more particularly, but not by way of limitation, to techniques for validation of a software

development process, such as a software development pipeline.

BACKGROUND

(2) Computer systems and software have become an integral part of modern society and affect a variety of aspects of daily life. Software can be developed as a monolith, such as one piece of software, or as a service-oriented architecture where each piece of software provides a specific service and multiple pieces of software operate together. Software can be updated to add or remove functionality, to correct bugs (e.g., critical/functional issues), and/or to address security issues. To update a piece of software, a new version is developed and deployed to a device, such as a software consumable device that stores and executes the new version of the software.

(3) As part of generating a software release, software (e.g., one or more files) may undergo one or more development stages of a development process. For example, a continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipeline may be configured at one or more computing devices for performing the development stages of the development process to build and deploy a software release. Some of these development stages include generating software builds and performing different types of tests on the builds. However, once the software release is finalized and deployed, there is no way to validate that the software release successfully completed each of the one or more development stages and that the software release has not been altered after completing each of the one or more development stages. For example, a malicious programmer may alter code after completion of one or more development stages or may provide additional code that has not undergone the one or more development stages. Executing software that cannot be validated as secure after the development process can lead to problems, such as vulnerabilities in a computer system that executes the software.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(4) Aspects of the present disclosure provide systems, methods, and computer-readable storage media that provide techniques for verifying completion of one or more stages of a multi-stage development process, such as a CI/CD pipeline process, for a software release and for validating information generated by the one or more stages using validation information provided with the software release. To illustrate, a server (e.g., a deployment system/application) may obtain files generated during performance of multiple development stages of a development process for a software release. For example, the server may perform the development stages to generate the files (e.g., software) or the server may receive the files from an entity device that performs the development stages. In addition to generating the files after completion of the multiple development stages, initiating or performing some or all of the development process (e.g., a pipeline run) may generate data components (e.g., segments) of development data. For example, initiating the development process may generate head data, performance of each development stage may generate stage data (also referred to as “run data”) for the development stage, and completion of the development process may generate development information (e.g., run component data). To further illustrate, the head data may include name and version information as well as a full configuration at the time the development process is initiated. The stage data may include configuration data, inputs, outputs, start times, end times, authors, pass/fail information, and/or other information associated with the respective development stage. The development information (e.g., the run component data) may include a completion time and reference to each of the other run components, such as an ordered list of hashes of the head data and the stage data of each development stage.

(5) The server may generate a digital signature for one or more of data components (e.g., the head data, the stage data for the multiple development stages, and the development data (also referred to as “information” or “info”)), or all of the components, based on initial pipeline data, the stage data associated with the one or more development stages, and information associated with completion of all of the development stages. The server may generate the digital signatures using a private key of a private/public key pair that is generated based on a master key that is accessible to the server. In

some implementations, the server may “stringify” (e.g., serially aggregate and convert to a string value) or otherwise package an entirety of the stage data for a development stage (or other data component/segment) in order to generate the digital signature for the development stage (or other data component). In some other implementations, the server may generate a hash value based on the stage data (or other data component), or otherwise compress the stage data (or other data component) in a reproducible way in order, and the hash or compressed version is signed to reduce the size of the digital signature.

(6) The server may store the generated digital signatures as entries in a secure data structure, such as a private blockchain or other data structure that is configured for serial addition of entries such that each subsequent entry is based at least in part on a previous entry. In some implementations, the digital signatures may be stored in a tree structure, such as a Merkle tree as a non-limiting example, either as a blockchain or in a database accessible to node devices. As entries are generated during the development process, the secure data structure may be considered “append only” as each entry is based at least in part on a previous entry. After completion of the development process, the private key may be discarded, such that the secure data structure becomes “read only.” In some implementations, after addition of a last (e.g., final) entry into the secure data structure, the server may encrypt the secure data structure using a storage key, such as the master key or a different encryption key that is accessible to node devices. After the performance of the multiple development stages (e.g., the development process) are complete, the server may discard the private key and may provide the files and validation information to a node device (e.g., an edge device or customer device). The validation information includes the secure data structure, the data components, and the public key. To illustrate, the server may store the validation information in a database, or the server may transmit the validation information and the files to the node device.

(7) After receipt of the files and the validation information, the node device may validate that the files have completed the development stages, and have not been subsequently altered, using the validation information. To illustrate, the node device may validate the received stage data for a particular development stage by generating a validation signature based on the stage data for the particular development stage and the public key. As another example, the node device may generate a validation signature for the head data by signing the head data (or a hash thereof) using the public key. The node device may compare the generated validation signature to the corresponding digital signature for the particular data component that is stored in the secure data structure. If the validation signature matches the corresponding digital signature, the node device validates that the files have completed the particular development stage (or an entirety of the development process) without being altered. If the validation signature fails to match the corresponding digital signature, validation fails. The node device may process the received files based on a successful validation, and the node device may perform one or more recovery options, such as discarding the files, transmitting a message to the server, and the like, based on a failed validation. Because the secure data structure (e.g., the private blockchain) is immutable and can no longer be altered after loss of the private key, a malicious actor is unable to alter the secure data structure without being detected. Thus, use of the secure data structure that stores the digital signatures enables validation, at the node device, that the received files have undergone the development stages of the development process and remain unaltered. Additionally, the node device may validate that the received stage data accurately reflects the corresponding development stage(s) of the development process. Thus, improved security of software releases may be provided through the sharing of a secured data structure that includes multiple digital signatures, which may reduce or eliminate execution of unverified software at the node device.

(8) According to one aspect, a method for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The method includes obtaining, by one or more processors, one or more files associated with the software release based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages.

Performance of at least a portion of the development process generates data components associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The method also includes generating, by the one or more processors, a private key and a public key based on a master key accessible to the one or more processors. The method includes, for each of the data components, generating, by the one or more processors, a digital signature based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key, and adding, by the one or more processors, an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure accessible to one or more node devices. The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. The method further includes initiating, by the one or more processors, transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices.

(9) According to another aspect, a system for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The system includes at least one memory storing instructions and one or more processors coupled to the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to cause the one or more processors to obtain one or more files associated with the software release based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages. Performance of at least a portion of the development process generates data components associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The one or more processors are also configured to generate a private key and a public key based on a master key accessible to the one or more processors. The one or more processors are configured to, for each of the data components, generate a digital signature based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key and add an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure accessible to the one or more node devices. The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. The one or more processors are further configured to initiate transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices.

(10) According to another aspect, a computer program product is described that includes a computer-readable storage device, such as a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, that includes instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform operations for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages. The operations include obtaining one or more files associated with the software release based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages. Performance of at least the portion of the development process generates data components associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The operations also include generating a private key and a public key based on a master key accessible to the one or more processors. The operations include, for each of the data components, generating a digital signature based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key and adding an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure accessible to one or more node devices. The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. The operations further include initiating transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices.

(11) According to another aspect, a method for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The method includes receiving, by one or more processors, one or more files of the deployed software release and validation information including data components associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages. The method also includes accessing, by the one or more processors, a secure data structure and a public key associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a

private key used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The method also includes validating the one or more digital signatures by, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure, generating, by the one or more processors, a validation signature based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key, and comparing, by the one or more processors, the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The method further includes processing, by the one or more processors, the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

(12) According to another aspect, a system for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The system includes at least one memory storing instructions and one or more processors coupled to the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to cause the one or more processors to receive one or more files of the deployed software release and validation information including data components associated with a development process that include the multiple development stages. The one or more processors are also configured to access a secure data structure and a public key associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The one or more processors are also configured to, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure to validate the one or more digital signatures, generate a validation signature based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key, and compare the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The one or more processors are further configured to process the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

(13) According to another aspect, a computer program product is described that includes a computer-readable storage device, such as a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, that includes instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform operations for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages. The operations include receiving one or more files of the deployed software release and validation information including data components associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages. The operations also include accessing a secure data structure and a public key associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The operations also include validating the one or more digital signatures by, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure, generating a validation signature based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key, and comparing the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The operations further include processing the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

(14) The foregoing has outlined rather broadly the features and technical advantages of the present disclosure in order that the detailed description that follows may be better understood. Additional features and advantages will be described hereinafter which form the subject of the claims of the present disclosure. It should be appreciated by those skilled in the art that the conception and specific implementations disclosed may be readily utilized as a basis for modifying or designing other structures for carrying out the same purposes of the present disclosure. It should also be realized by those skilled in the art that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the scope of the present disclosure as set forth in the appended claims. The novel features which are believed to be characteristic of the embodiments, both as to its organization and method of operation, together with further objects and advantages will be better understood from the following description when considered in connection with the accompanying figures. It is to be expressly

understood, however, that each of the figures is provided for the purpose of illustration and description only and is not intended as a definition of the limits of the present disclosure.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) For a more complete understanding of the present disclosure, reference is now made to the following descriptions taken in conjunction with the accompanying figures, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an example of a system that includes a server for sharing validation information of a software release;
- (3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of another example of a system for sharing validation information of a software release;
- (4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of another example of a system for sharing validation information of a software release;
- (5) FIG. 4 is a block diagram of another example of a system for sharing validation information of a software release;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram of an example of data components and a tree structure for validating a software release;
- (7) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example of multiple development stages of a software release;
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates an example of data components used to generate digital signatures for validating a software release;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a flow diagram of an example of a method for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages; and
- (10) FIG. 9 is a flow diagram of an example of a method for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages.
- (11) Although the present disclosure and its advantages have been described in detail, it should be understood that various changes, substitutions and alterations can be made herein without departing from the scope of the disclosure as defined by the appended claims. Moreover, the scope of the present application is not intended to be limited to the particular embodiments of the process, machine, manufacture, composition of matter, means, methods and steps described in the specification. As one of ordinary skill in the art will readily appreciate from the present disclosure, processes, machines, manufacture, compositions of matter, means, methods, or steps, presently existing or later to be developed that perform substantially the same function or achieve substantially the same result as the corresponding embodiments described herein may be utilized according to the present disclosure. Accordingly, the appended claims are intended to include within their scope such processes, machines, manufacture, compositions of matter, means, methods, or steps.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (12) Inventive concepts of the present disclosure utilize a system to share validation information and to verify completion of a development process by a software release and to validate information generated during the development process. To illustrate, a software release (e.g., one or more files or artifacts) may undergo a development process, at an entity device or a server, that includes multiple development stages. Upon completion of at least a portion of the development process, data components for the portion of development process may be generated, such as head data, stage data (also referred to as “run data,”) for one or more of the multiple development stages, development completion data (also referred to as “run component data”), or a combination thereof. As a non-limiting example, the head data may include configuration data associated with the development process, or stage data for a development stage may include inputs, outputs, start times, end times, authors, success indications, and/or other information associated with the development

stage. A server may generate a digital signature for the data components based on the respective data component and a private key of a private/public key pair. For example, a first digital signature may be generated based on head data from an initiation of the development process and a private key, a second digital signature may be generated based on stage data from a unit test (or other development stage) and the private key, and a third digital signature may be generated based on stage data from an integration test (or other development stage) and the private key. The private/public key pair (e.g., the private key and a corresponding public key) may be generated based on a master key and may only be used to generate the digital signatures. The data components may be aggregated and converted to a string, or another data type, for use in generating the digital signature, or a hash value may be generated based on the data component and the hash value may be used to generate the digital signature. The digital signatures may be stored in a secure data structure that is immutable to other devices without the private key. The secure data structure may be implemented as a distributed data structure, such as a private blockchain, a tree structure, or the like. After completion of the development process, and storage of all the digital signatures in the secure data structure, the private key may be discarded, transitioning the secure data structure from append-only to read-only (e.g., via a public key).

(13) The data components may be transferred as validation data along with the software release from the server to one or more node devices, which are also able to access the secure data structure and the public key. Transmission of the validation information enables the one or more node devices to verify that the software release (e.g., the one or more files) has successfully completed the multiple development stages of the development process and to validate that the data components are accurate and have not been tampered with after completion of the development process. For example, the server may deploy the software release by transmitting the one or more files (or the files that are not already stored at the one or more node devices) together with the validation information, and other metadata. Based on receipt of the validation information, the one or more node devices may validate the one or more files and the data components. For example, a node device may generate a first validation signature based on a first data component and the public key, and the node device may compare the first validation signature to a first digital signature stored in the secure data structure. If the first validation signature matches the first digital signature, the node device may validate that the first data component is accurate. Validating each of the data components in this manner verifies that the one or more files completed the respective development stages of the development process and validates that the received data components are accurate and have not been altered by a malicious actor.

(14) Based on verifying that the one or more files have completed the multiple development stages/development process and that the data components are validated, the node device may process the one or more files. For example, the node device may transfer the one or more files from a transaction directory to another memory location for execution and setting a flag to indicate that the one or more files have completed the multiple development stages/development process. If the node device is unable to verify that the one or more files have completed the multiple development stages/development process and validate the data components, the node device may send a notification to the server and/or delete (or otherwise discard) the one or more files from the transaction directory. Thus, the node device may advantageously verify whether a software release has completed the multiple development stages of the development process and validate the data components before processing the software, thereby preventing the node device from processing unverified software, which may open the node device to vulnerabilities. Stated another way, the node device is able to verify that the same software that passed a development stage is the software that is received, and that the software has not been altered since the software passed the development stage.

(15) Certain units described in this specification have been labeled as modules in order to more particularly emphasize their implementation independence. A module is “[a] self-contained

hardware or software component that interacts with a larger system.” Alan Freedman, “The Computer Glossary” 268 (8th ed. 1998). A module may comprise a machine- or machines-executable instructions. For example, a module may be implemented as a hardware circuit comprising custom VLSI circuits or gate arrays, off-the-shelf semiconductors such as logic chips, transistors, or other discrete components. A module may also be implemented in programmable hardware devices such as field programmable gate arrays, programmable array logic, programmable logic devices or the like.

(16) Modules may also include software-defined units or instructions, that when executed by a processing machine or device, transform data stored on a data storage device from a first state to a second state. An identified module of executable code may, for instance, comprise one or more physical or logical blocks of computer instructions that may be organized as an object, procedure, or function. Nevertheless, the executables of an identified module need not be physically located together, but may comprise disparate instructions stored in different locations that, when joined logically together, comprise the module, and when executed by the processor, achieve the stated data transformation. A module of executable code may be a single instruction, or many instructions, and may even be distributed over several different code segments, among different programs, and/or across several memory devices. Similarly, operational data may be identified and illustrated herein within modules, and may be embodied in any suitable form and organized within any suitable type of data structure. The operational data may be collected as a single data set, or may be distributed over different locations including over different storage devices.

(17) In the following description, numerous specific details are provided, such as examples of programming, software modules, user selections, network transactions, database queries, database structures, hardware modules, hardware circuits, hardware chips, etc., to provide a thorough understanding of the present embodiments. One skilled in the relevant art will recognize, however, that aspects of the disclosure may be practiced without one or more of the specific details, or with other methods, components, materials, and so forth. In other instances, well-known structures, materials, or operations are not shown or described in detail to avoid obscuring aspects of the disclosure.

(18) As used herein, various terminology is for the purpose of describing particular implementations only and is not intended to be limiting of implementations. For example, as used herein, an ordinal term (e.g., “first,” “second,” “third,” etc.) used to modify an element, such as a structure, a component, an operation, etc., does not by itself indicate any priority or order of the element with respect to another element, but rather merely distinguishes the element from another element having a same name (but for use of the ordinal term). The term “coupled” is defined as connected, although not necessarily directly, and not necessarily mechanically; two items that are “coupled” may be unitary with each other. The terms “a” and “an” are defined as one or more unless this disclosure explicitly requires otherwise. The term “substantially” is defined as largely but not necessarily wholly what is specified (and includes what is specified; e.g., substantially 90 degrees includes 90 degrees and substantially parallel includes parallel), as understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art. In any disclosed embodiment, the term “substantially” may be substituted with “within [a percentage] of” what is specified, where the percentage includes 0.1, 1, or 5 percent; and the term “approximately” may be substituted with “within 10 percent of” what is specified. The phrase “and/or” means and or or. To illustrate, A, B, and/or C includes: A alone, B alone, C alone, a combination of A and B, a combination of A and C, a combination of B and C, or a combination of A, B, and C. In other words, “and/or” operates as an inclusive or. Similarly, the phrase “A, B, C, or a combination thereof” or “A, B, C, or any combination thereof” includes A alone, B alone, C alone, a combination of A and B, a combination of A and C, a combination of B and C, or a combination of A, B, and C.

(19) The terms “comprise” (and any form of comprise, such as “comprises” and “comprising”), “have” (and any form of have, such as “has” and “having”), and “include” (and any form of

include, such as “includes” and “including”). As a result, an apparatus that “comprises,” “has,” or “includes” one or more elements possesses those one or more elements, but is not limited to possessing only those one or more elements. Likewise, a method that “comprises,” “has,” or “includes” one or more steps possesses those one or more steps, but is not limited to possessing only those one or more steps.

(20) Any embodiment of any of the systems, methods, and article of manufacture can consist of or consist essentially of—rather than comprise/have/include—any of the described steps, elements, and/or features. Thus, in any of the claims, the term “consisting of” or “consisting essentially of” can be substituted for any of the open-ended linking verbs recited above, in order to change the scope of a given claim from what it would otherwise be using the open-ended linking verb. Additionally, the term “wherein” may be used interchangeably with “where.”

(21) Further, a device or system that is configured in a certain way is configured in at least that way, but it can also be configured in other ways than those specifically described. The feature or features of one embodiment may be applied to other embodiments, even though not described or illustrated, unless expressly prohibited by this disclosure or the nature of the embodiments.

(22) Referring to FIG. 1, a block diagram of a system that includes a server for sharing validation information of a software release according to one or more aspects is shown and designated **100**. System **100** includes a server **110** (e.g., a first repository server), a network **120**, data sources **130**, an entity server **140**, an entity **150**, a node device **160**, a server **168** (e.g., a second repository server), and user equipment **170**.

(23) Server **110** may include one or more servers that, according to some implementations, are configured to perform several of the functions and/or operations described herein. One or more of the servers comprising server **110** may include memory, storage hardware, software residing thereon, and one or more processors configured to perform functions associated with system **100**, as described further herein at least with reference to FIGS. 2-4. One of skill in the art will readily recognize that different server and computer architectures can be utilized to implement server **110**, and that server **110** is not limited to a particular architecture so long as the hardware implementing server **110** supports the functions of the system disclosed herein. As shown in FIG. 1, user equipment can be used to enable an owner and/or administrator of server **110** to access and modify aspects (e.g., instructions, applications, data) of server **110**. For example, components comprising user equipment **170**, such as one or more processors **172**, can be used to interface with and/or implement the server **110**. Accordingly, user equipment **170** (e.g., a user station) may serve as a repository portal by which a user may access a repository system, such as a universal artifact repository, disclosed herein. For example, an artifact repository system may include server **110** (e.g., a first server) and server **168** (e.g., a second server). The portal can function to allow multiple users, inside and outside system **100** (e.g., at multiple instances of user equipment **170**), to interface with one another. Additionally, it is noted that the one or more components described with reference to user equipment **170** may also be included in one or more of server **110**, entity server **140**, entity **150**, node device **160**, and/or server **168**.

(24) As shown, server **110** includes one or more artifacts **114** and software release **115**. Artifacts **114** may include one or more binaries (e.g., a computer file that is not a text file). The artifacts may correspond to one or more package types. For example, a first artifact may correspond to a first package type, such as Maven, and a second artifact may correspond to a second package type, such as Bower. Software release **115** may include software **116** (e.g., one or more of artifacts **114**) and software release information that includes validation information **118**. Validation information **118** may include stage data, a public key, and a secure data structure that stores one or more digital signatures. Each digital signature in the secure data structure and each piece of stage data (also referred to as run data) may correspond to a development stage of multiple development stages of a development process of software **116**. For example, as described further herein, software **116** may be generated by entity **150** and/or entity server **140**, or by server **110**, by undergoing multiple

development stages. The multiple digital signatures may indicate successful completion of a corresponding development stage, the stage data may be generated during completion of a corresponding development stage, and the stage data and digital signatures may be used by node device **160** to verify completion of the multiple development stages and to validate the received stage data, as further described herein.

(25) Network **120**, such as a communication network, may facilitate communication of data between server **110** and other components, servers/processors, and/or devices. For example, network **120** may also facilitate communication of data between server **110** and one or more data sources **130**, entity server **140**, a node device **160**, server **168**, or any combination thereof. Network **120** may include a wired network, a wireless network, or a combination thereof. For example, network **120** may include any type of communications network, such as a direct PC-to-PC connection, a local area network (LAN), a wide area network (WAN), a modem-to-modem connection, the Internet, intranet, extranet, cable transmission system, cellular communication network, any combination of the above, or any other communications network now known or later developed within which permits two or more electronic devices to communicate.

(26) Data sources **130** include the sources from which server **110** collects information. For example, data sources may include one or more reciprocities of artifacts, such as open source artifacts, vulnerability data, and/or license data, as illustrative, non-limiting examples.

(27) Entity server **140** may include one or more servers which entity **150** uses to support its operations. In some implementations, entity server **140** may support a development process **142** that includes multiple development stages for generating software for a software release. In such implementations, entity **150** includes or is configured to generate (or initiate generation of) software **116** (e.g., one or more files). Software **116** includes one or more files (e.g., artifacts) to be included in a software release. For example, software **116** may correspond to a build job generated by a continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipeline. In some implementations, after performance of development process **142**, entity **150** provides software **116**, or software information indicating the files included in software **116**, to server **110**. In other implementations, entity **150** provides a query and/or one or more parameters for a query which is performed by server **110** to generate the software information at server **110**. To illustrate, entity **150** may initiate a query by server **110** to identify one or more files corresponding to a particular build job identifier. The software information may be used to generate a software release, as further described herein.

(28) Entity **150** may include any individual, organization, company, corporation, department (e.g., government), or group of individuals. For example, one entity may be a corporation with retail locations spread across multiple geographic regions (e.g., counties, states, or countries). As another example, another entity may be a corporation with cruise ships. As another example, another entity may be a group of one or more individuals. In a particular implementation, entity **150** includes a business and at least one user who can access server **110**. For example, the user may access server **110** via an application, such as an application hosted by server **110**. To illustrate, the user may have an account (e.g., on behalf of entity **150**) and may log in to server **110** via the application. Although system **100** shows one entity **150**, in other implementations, system **100** includes multiple entities. In a particular implementation, the multiple entities may include a first entity and a second entity, as described further herein at least with reference to FIG. 2. In such implementations, the first entity and the second entity may be the same entity (e.g., part of the same company) or may be different entities.

(29) Node device **160** includes software **116** and software release information that includes validation information **118** (including data components such as head data, stage data, development completion data, or the like). A public key and a secure data structure storing one or more digital signatures may be made accessible to one or more devices, such as node device **160**, or optionally be included in validation information **118**. To illustrate, software (e.g., packages) hosted at node device **160** may be part of a software release which is a secure and immutable collection of

software packages that make up a software release. Node device **160** also includes validation information **118**, for use in verifying that software **116** has completed at least a portion of (e.g., one or more of the multiple development stages of) development process **142**, that the received data components are valid, and that software **116** and the stage data have not been altered by another party, as further described herein with reference to FIGS. 2-4.

(30) In some implementations, node device **160** may include or correspond to entity **150**. Although system **100** is shown as having one node device **160**, in other implementations, the system **100** may include multiple node devices (e.g., **160**). Node device **160** may include a data center, a point-of-sale device, a mobile device, or an Internet of things (IoT) device. In some implementations, node device **160** includes a communications device, a fixed location data unit, a mobile location data unit, a mobile phone, a cellular phone, a satellite phone, a computer, a tablet, a portable computer, a wearable device, a display device, a media player, or a desktop computer. Alternatively, or additionally, node device **160** may include a set top box, an entertainment unit, a navigation device, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a monitor, a computer monitor, a television, a tuner, a radio, a satellite radio, a music player, a digital music player, a portable music player, a video player, a digital video player, an augmented reality (AR) device, a virtual reality (VR) device, an extended reality (XR) device, a digital video disc (DVD) player, a portable digital video player, a satellite, a vehicle or a device integrated within a vehicle, any other device that includes a processor or that stores or retrieves data or computer instructions, or a combination thereof. In other illustrative, non-limiting examples, node device **160** may include remote units, such as hand-held personal communication systems (PCS) units, portable data units such as global positioning system (GPS) enabled devices, meter reading equipment, or any other device that includes a processor or that stores or retrieves data or computer instructions, or any combination thereof.

(31) Server **168** may be a repository server and may include or correspond to server **110**. In some implementations, server **110** and server **168** may be included in a universal artifact management system. Server **110** and server **168** may execute different environments while sharing artifacts **114**. In some implementations, server **168** receives software release **115** (e.g., software **116** and software release information including validation information **118**) and supplies software release **115** to node device **160**.

(32) With respect to user equipment **170**, user equipment **170** may include one or more processors **172**, memory **174**, a communication adapter **176**, an input/output (I/O) adapter **178**, a display adapter **180**, a user interface adapter **182**, and a bus **184**. As shown, each of one or more processors **172**, such as a central processing unit (CPU), memory **174**, communication adapter **176**, I/O adapter **178**, display adapter **180**, and user interface adapter **182** are coupled to/via bus **184**. As noted above, one or more components of user equipment **170** may also be included in one or more other devices, such as server **110**, to enable and/or support operations and functionality at the other device.

(33) One or more processors **172** may include a CPU or microprocessor, a graphics processing unit ("GPU"), and/or microcontroller that has been programmed to perform the functions of user equipment **170**. Implementations described herein are not restricted by the architecture of one or more processors **172** so long as one or more processors **172**, whether directly or indirectly, support the operations described herein. One or more processors **172** may be one component or multiple components that may execute the various described logical instructions.

(34) Memory **174** includes read only memory (ROM) **186** and random access memory (RAM) **188**. ROM **186** may store configuration information for booting user equipment **170**. ROM **186** can include programmable read-only memory (PROM), erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), optical storage, or the like. User equipment **170** may utilize RAM **188** to store the various data structures used by a software application. RAM **188** can include synchronous RAM (SRAM), dynamic RAM (DRAM), synchronous dynamic RAM (SDRAM), or the like. ROM **186** and RAM **188** hold user and system

data, and both ROM **186** and RAM **188** may be randomly accessed. In some implementations, memory **174** may store the instructions that, when executed by one or more processor **172**, cause the one or more processors **172** to perform operations according to aspects of the present disclosure, as described herein.

(35) Communications adapter **176** can be adapted to couple user equipment **170** to a network, which can be one or more of a LAN, WAN, and/or the Internet. Therefore, in some aspects, server **110** may be accessed via an online portal. I/O adapter **178** may couple user equipment **170** to one or more storage devices **190**, such as one or more of a hard drive, a solid state storage device, a flash drive, a compact disc (CD) drive, a floppy disk drive, a tape drive, and/or the like. Also, data storage devices **190** can be a separate server coupled to user equipment **170** through a network connection to I/O adapter **178**. Display adapter **180** can be driven by one or more processors **172** to control presentation via display device **192**. In some implementations, display adapter **180** may display a graphical user interface (GUI) associated with a software or web-based application on display device **192**, such as a monitor or touch screen. User interface adapter **182** couples user interface device **194**, such as a keyboard, a pointing device, and/or a touch screen to the user equipment **170**. The I/O adapter **178** and/or the user interface adapter **182** may, in certain aspects, enable a user to interact with user equipment **170**. Any of devices **172-184** may be physical and/or logical.

(36) The concepts described herein are not limited to the architecture of user equipment **170**. Rather, user equipment **170** is provided as an example of one type of computing device that can be adapted to perform the functions of server **110** and/or a user interface device. For example, any suitable processor-based device can be utilized including, without limitation, personal data assistants (PDAs), tablet computers, smartphones, wearable devices, computer game consoles, multi-processor servers, and the like. Moreover, the systems and methods of the present disclosure can be implemented on application specific integrated circuits (ASIC), very large scale integrated (VLSI) circuits, or other circuitry. In fact, persons of ordinary skill in the art may utilize any number of suitable structures capable of executing logical operations according to the described embodiments. Additionally, it should be appreciated that user equipment **170**, or certain components thereof, may reside at, or be installed in, different locations within system **100**.

(37) In some implementations, server **110** (and/or server **168**) can comprise a server and/or cloud-based computing platform configured to perform operations and/or execute the steps described herein. Accordingly, server **110** (and/or server **168**) may include a particular purpose computing system designed, configured, or adapted to perform and/or initiate operations, functions, processes, and/or methods described herein and can be communicatively coupled with a number of end user devices (e.g., user equipment **170**), which can be, e.g., a computer, tablet, smartphone, wearable device, or other similar end user computing device. Users can interact with server **110** (and/or server **168**) using a device via one or more networks, such as network **120**, which itself can comprise one or more of a local intranet, a Local Area Network (LAN), a Wide Area Network (WAN), a virtual private network (VPN), and the like. As will be apparent to those of skill in the art, communicative coupling between different devices of system **100** can be provided by, e.g., one or more of wireless connections, a synchronous optical network (SONET) connection, a digital T1, TN, E1 or E3 line, Digital Data Service (DDS) connection, DSL (Digital Subscriber Line) connection, an Ethernet connection, and the like.

(38) Referring to FIG. 2, a block diagram of a system for sharing validation information of a software release according to one or more aspects is shown as a system **200**. System **200** may include or correspond to at least a portion of system **100**. System **200** includes server **110**, networks **120a**, **120b**, entities **150a**, **150b**, node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**, and server **168**. As shown in FIG. 2, system **200** is spread across multiple regions, such as a first region **202** and a second region **204**. For example, each region may correspond to a different city, county, state, country, continent, or other physical or logical distinction. To illustrate, first region **202** may include or correspond to

North America (e.g., the United States) and second region **204** may include or correspond to Asia (e.g., Japan), as a non-limiting example.

(39) As shown, server **110** is included in first region **202** and server **168** is included in second region **204**. Server **168** may be a repository server and may include or correspond to server **110**. In some implementations, server **110** and server **168** may be included in a universal artifact management system. Networks **120a**, **120b** may include or correspond to network **120** of FIG. 1. Each of the entities **150a**, **150b** may include or correspond to entity **150** of FIG. 1. In some implementations, a first entity **150a** and a second entity **150b** may be part of the same group, company, etc., or may be part of different groups, companies, etc. Each of node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d** may include or correspond to node device **160** of FIG. 1. In some implementations, each of node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d** corresponds to the same entity. In other implementations, at least one node device of node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d** corresponds to another entity.

(40) Server **110** may include a memory **210** (e.g., one or more memory devices), one or more processors **250**, and a network interface **270**. Network interface **270** may be configured to be communicatively coupled, via one or more networks (e.g., **120a**, **120b**) to one or more external devices, such as one or more entities (e.g., **150a**, **150b**), one or more node devices (e.g., **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**), one or more servers (e.g., **168**), one or more data sources (e.g., **130**), or any combination thereof. For example, network interface **270** may include a transmitter, a receiver, or a combination thereof (e.g., a transceiver).

(41) Memory **210** may include ROM devices, RAM devices, one or more HDDs, flash memory devices, SSDs, other devices configured to store data in a persistent or non-persistent state, or a combination of different memory devices. Memory **210** includes (e.g., is configured to store) instructions **212**, thresholds **216**, artifacts **218** (e.g., binaries), meta data **220**, software release **115**, and entity data **230**. For example, memory **210** may store instructions **212**, that when executed by one or more processors **250**, cause the processor **250** to perform functions, methods, processes, and/or operations as described further herein. In some implementations, instructions **212** may include or be arranged as an application **214** (e.g., a software program) associated with a universal artifact repository. For example, application **214** may provide a portal via which one or more entities and/or users interact with and access server **110**. Application **284** at entity **150a** and application **294** at node device **160a** are configured to enable entity **150a** and node device **160a** to communicate with and/or access server **110**. In some implementations, each of application **284** and application **294** enable functionality as described with respect to server **110**. In other implementations, application **284** and application **294** may enable and/or support less than all of the functionality as described with reference to server **110**. To illustrate, application **294** may not provide functionality as described with reference to analyzer **258**.

(42) In some implementations, memory **210** includes multiple memories accessible by one or more processors **250**. In some such implementations, one or more of the memories may be external to server **110**. To illustrate, at least one memory may include or correspond to a database accessible to server **110**, such as a database that stores one or more thresholds **216**, artifacts **218**, meta data **220**, software release **115**, entity data **230**, or any combination thereof. In some implementations, memory **210** may include or be coupled to cloud storage such that one or more thresholds **216**, one or more of artifacts **218**, meta data **220**, software release **115**, and/or entity data **230** is stored at a cloud storage location and accessible by server **110**.

(43) Thresholds **216** may include or correspond to one or more thresholds, such as a time period threshold, a size threshold, etc. Artifacts **218** may include or correspond to artifacts **114** of FIG. 1. Meta data **220** may include meta data for artifacts **114**, meta data for application **214**, meta data for one or more files (e.g., **116**), meta data for validation information, or any combination thereof. Meta data for an artifact (e.g., **114**) may include a file name, a file size, a checksum of the file, and/or one or more properties that annotate the artifact, such as when the artifact was created by a build, a

build job name, an identifier of who initiated the build, a time the build was initiated, a build agent, a CI server, a build job number, and/or a quality assurance test passed indicator, as illustrative, non-limiting examples.

(44) Software release **115** includes software **116** and software release information. Software release information includes information corresponding to software **116**, such as one or more checksums, meta data, or a combination thereof. The software release information may also include validation information **118**. Software **116** may include one or more files (e.g., one or more of artifacts **218**), and may correspond to a build job. Software **116** may be designated for distribution to entity or node devices as part of software release **115**. Validation information **118** includes data components, such as head data, stage data, and/or development completion data (and optionally a public key and a secure data structure that stores one or more digital signatures, or the public key and secure data structure may be otherwise accessible to devices such as node device). The data components may include information generated by or associated with general parameters of a development process and/or information associated with one or more development stages, such as configuration data, inputs, outputs, an author associated with the development stage (or of the signature), a start time of the development stage, an end time of the development stage, an indicator of success for the development stage, a time of the signature, a date of the signature, a development stage or other component associated with the signature, etc. The public key may be part of a private/public key pair and may enable generation of validation signatures by node devices. The secure data structure may be any data structure, such as a private blockchain, a tree structure, or the like, that is immutable to devices other than server **110** and that is configured for storage of information in a serial order (e.g., a second entry in the secure data structure is based at least in part on a first entry in the secure data structure) or in hierarchical order.

(45) Entity data **230** may include data associated with one or more entities. For example, entity data **230** may include or correspond to one or more of entity **150a**, **150b**. Entity data **230** may include one or more credentials **232**, package type information **234**, and a node device log **236**. Credentials **232** include login information to enable one or more users and/or one or more entities to access server **110**. Additionally, or alternatively, credentials **232** may include security or authentication information, such as a private key, a public key, and/or a token of a user and/or entity. Package type information **234** may identify one or more package types used by the corresponding entity. As illustrative, non-limiting examples, the one or more package types may include Bower, Chef, CocoaPods, Conan, Conda, CRAN, Debian, Docker, Git LFS, Go, Helm, Maven, npm, NuGet, Opkg, P2, PHP Composer, Puppet, PyPI, RPM, RubyGems, SBT, Vagrant, and VCS. Node device log **236** includes node device information of one or more node devices corresponding to an entity of entity data **230**. To illustrate, node device log **236** may include topology information (e.g., location information) of one or more node devices, one or more node device identifiers, owner/manager information, file and/or software information (e.g., name, version number, size, etc.) installed at one or more node devices, or any combination thereof, as illustrative, non-limiting examples. In some implementations, node device log **236** may indicate a list of target nodes at which one or more security objects are to be synchronized or software release **115** is to be deployed.

(46) Processor **250** may include may be a CPU (e.g., processor **172**) or microprocessor, a graphics processing unit (“GPU”), a field-programmable gate array (FPGA) device, an application-specific integrated circuits (ASIC), another hardware device, a firmware device, a microcontroller, or any combination thereof that has been programmed to perform the functions described herein. As shown in FIG. 2, in some implementations, server **110** (e.g., processor **250**) may include a manager **252**, a deployer **253**, a replicator **254**, a tracker **256**, an analyzer **258**, and an indexer **260**. In some implementations, processor **250** may include one or more modules. For example, each of manager **252**, deployer **253**, replicator **254**, tracker **256**, analyzer **258**, and indexer **260** may include or correspond to one or more modules. In some implementations, server **110** (e.g., processor **250** or

modules **252, 253, 254, 256, 258, 260**) may be configured to execute one or more routines that perform various operations as described further herein. A module is “[a] self-contained hardware or software component that interacts with a larger system.” Alan Freedman, “The Computer Glossary” **268** (8th ed. 1998). A module may comprise a machine- or machines-executable instructions. A module may also be implemented in programmable hardware devices such as field programmable gate arrays, programmable array logic, programmable logic devices or the like. Modules may also include software-defined units or instructions, that when executed by a processing machine or device, transform data stored on a data storage device from a first state to a second state. Modules may be separate or two or more may be combined.

(47) In some implementations, one or more of modules (e.g., **252, 253, 254, 256, 258, 260**) may locally reside in memory **210** or in a separate location. Further, as will be understood by those of skill in the art, a “module” can include an application-specific integrated circuit (“ASIC”), an electronic circuit, a processor (shared, dedicated, or group) that executes one or more of software or firmware, a combinational logic circuit, and/or other suitable components that provide the described functionality.

(48) Referring to processor **250**, manager **252** may be configured to enable a user (e.g., **150a**) to manage one or more other components/modules (e.g., **253, 254, 256, 258, 260**) of processor **250**. Additionally, or alternatively, manager **252** may enable storage of and/or access to one or more of artifacts **218**. In some implementations, manager **252** may enable administration of multiple instances of a user account, such as a first instance at server **110** and a second instance at server **168**. Accordingly, manager **252** may be configured to operate as an administrative tool that enables an entity (e.g., **150a**) to monitor and control a first instance of a user account (corresponding to first region **202**) and a second instance of the user account (corresponding to second region **204**). For example, the entity (e.g., **150a**) may be able to see which services (e.g., **253, 254, 256, 258, 260**) are operating in different regions, add/modify/remove individual users in different regions, set different permissions for individual users in different regions, provide and store one or more public keys, etc. In some implementations, manager **252** includes a manager module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., processor **172** of FIG. **1** or processor **250**) to enable a user (e.g., **150a**) to manage one or more other components/modules (e.g., **253, 254, 256, 258, 260**) of processor **250**, as described herein.

(49) Deployer **253** may be configured to perform a software release distribution. For example, deployer **253** provides a secure and structured platform to distribute and release binaries as a single coherent release bundle to multiple remote locations and update them as new release versions are produced. A release bundle may include one or more files and/or release bundle information which includes or indicates a list of the one or more files (e.g., artifacts) to be included in the release bundle and meta data (e.g., properties) associated with the release bundle. For example, software release **115** may include software **116** (e.g., one or more files) and software release information which includes metadata corresponding to software **116**. The release bundle information may include, for each file of the bundle release, a checksum (of the file), meta data (corresponding to the file), or both. In some implementations, the release bundle also includes additional meta data (e.g., file name, file size, path to the file, etc.) corresponding to the release bundle, such as a release bundle name, a version number, a source identifier, description information, release data, and/or a size. The software release information may also include validation information **118** which includes stage data, a public key, and a secure data structure that stores digital signatures and, in some implementations, digital signature metadata that corresponds to at least one of the digital signatures. Additionally, or alternatively, the software release information may include a signature (or other cryptography technique) to render the release bundle information immutable. In some implementations, the signature corresponding to the release bundle is different from the digital signatures (e.g., generated by development stages of the development process) stored in the secure data structure. In other implementations, one of the digital signatures stored in the secure data

structure may be used to render the release bundle information immutable.

(50) Deployer **253** may enable generation of a release bundle, auditing and traceability by tracking all changes associated with a release bundle distribution of the release bundle including permission levels release content, scheduling of a release bundle for distribution, tracking of a release bundle, stopping distribution of a release bundle, and/or selection of target destinations. Additionally, or alternatively, a software release may be provisioned amongst one or more node devices (e.g., **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**). In some implementations, as part of the release flow, release bundles are verified and validated by the source and/or destination to ensure that they are signed correctly and safe to use. In some implementations, deployer **253** includes a deployer module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., the processor **172** of FIG. **1** or processor **250**) to perform a software release distribution.

(51) Replicator **254** may be configured to coordinate and provide one or more artifacts (e.g., one or more files) and/or meta data between two or more devices. For example, replicator **254** may coordinate transfer of one or more artifacts (e.g., one or more files) and/or meta data between server **110** and server **168**, between server **110** and one or more of node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**, or both. In some implementations, replicator **254** is configured to be used in conjunction with deployer **253** to distribute a software release, provide efficient network utilization by optimizing replication, and reduce network load and/or release bundle synchronization time from source device (e.g., server **110**) to target instance (e.g., server **168**) or node device (e.g., **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**). Additionally, or alternatively, replicator **254** may be configured to identify a difference between at least one file stored at a first device (e.g., server **110**) and one or more files stored at a second device (e.g., server **168** or one of node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**), and initiate transfer of at least one or more portions of a file to the second device. In some implementations, replicator **254** includes a replicator module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., the processor **172** of FIG. **1** or processor **250**) to coordinate and provide one or more artifacts (e.g., one or more files) and/or meta data between two or more devices.

(52) Tracker **256** may be configured to track one or more artifacts, meta data, one or more release bundles, or any combination thereof deployed or attempted to be deployed to a node device, such as one or more of node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**, a server (e.g., server **110**, **168**), or both. In some implementations, tracker **256** includes a tracker module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., the processor **172** of FIG. **1** or processor **250**) to track one or more artifacts, meta data, one or more release bundles, or any combination thereof deployed or attempted to be deployed to a node device, such as one or more of node devices **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**, and/or one or more servers (e.g., server **110**, **168**).

(53) Analyzer **258** may be configured to analyze one or more artifacts (e.g., **218**) and/or meta data (e.g., **222**) to identify a vulnerability corresponding to the one or more artifacts, determine license compliance of the one or more artifacts, and/or determine an impact of an issue with a deployed file (e.g., artifact). In some implementations, analyzer **258** is configured to analyze data stored at memory **210**, identify issues related to deployed software, perform recursive scanning, and perform an impact analysis. In some implementations, analyzer **258** includes an analyzer module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., the processor **172** of FIG. **1** or processor **250**) to analyze one or more artifacts (e.g., **218**) and/or meta data (e.g., **222**) to identify a vulnerability corresponding to the one or more artifacts, determine license compliance of the one or more artifacts, and/or determine an impact of an issue with a deployed file (e.g., artifact).

(54) Indexer **260** may be configured to provide an indexing capability, including maintaining interdependencies and information, for one or more package types. Additionally, or alternatively, indexer **260** is configured to generate meta data (e.g., **220**), such as meta data defined by a universal artifact repository manager and utilized by one or more of manager **252**, deployer **253**, replicator **254**, tracker **256**, and analyzer **258**. In some implementations, indexer **260** includes an indexer module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., the

processor **172** of FIG. **1** or processor **250**) to provide an indexing capability, including maintaining interdependencies and information, for one or more package types.

(55) In some implementations, one or more of modules **252-260** may be optional. For example, in some implementations in which server **110** is configured to distribute software releases but not otherwise manage artifacts or files, processor **250** may include deployer **253** and manager **252**. In some other implementations, processor **250** may include multiple or all of modules **252-260**, and server **110** may be configured to deploy software releases in addition to operate as a universal artifact repository.

(56) FIGS. **3-4** are block diagrams of systems for sharing validation information of a software release according to one or more aspects. In some implementations shown in FIGS. **3-4**, the system of FIG. **3** includes a server that is configured to perform multiple development stages of a development process for a software release, and the system of FIG. **4** includes a server that receives stage data and software from an entity device configured to perform multiple development stages of a development process for a software release.

(57) Referring to FIG. **3**, a block diagram of a system for sharing validation information of a software release according to one or more aspects is shown and designated **300**. System **300** may include or correspond to at least a portion of system **100** and/or system **200**. System **300** includes a server **310** and a node device **360**. Server **310** and node device **360** may be coupled via one or more networks, such as network **120**. Server **310** may include or correspond to server **110**, server **168**, or a combination thereof. Node device **360** may include or correspond to node device **160**, **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, or **160d**.

(58) Server **310** includes one or more processors **312** and a memory **314**. Memory **314** may include or correspond to memory **210**. Memory **314** includes software **316** (e.g., one or more files/artifacts), data components **317**, a master key **324**, a public key **326**, a private key **328**, digital signatures **330**, a secure data structure **332**, and optionally a storage key **338**. The software **316** may include or correspond to software **116** and may include one or more of artifacts **114** and/or artifacts **218**. Data components **317** include data generated by initiation of a development process for a software release (e.g., for software **316**) or during performance of one or more development stages of the development process. For example, data components **317** may include head data **318**, stage data **319**, completed development information **323**, or a combination thereof. Head data **318** includes general parameters and data generated or available at initiation of the development process, such as name and version information as well as a full configuration data at the time the development process is initiated. Stage data **319** includes data generated during performance of one or more of the development stages, such as configuration data associated with the development stage, one or more inputs to the development stage, one or more outputs from the development stage, a start time for the development stage, an end time for the development stage, one or more authors associated with the development stage, a success indicator (e.g., a pass/fail indicator) for the development stage, or any combination thereof. In some implementations, stage data **319** includes first stage data **320** and second stage data **322**. In some other implementations, more than two stage data may be included in stage data **319**. Completed development information **323** (e.g., run component data) includes a completion time and references to each of the other data components/run components, such as an ordered list of hashes of head data **318** and stage data **319**.

(59) Master key **324** may include or correspond to a cryptographic key associated with a universal artifact repository or software release deployment supported by server **310**. Public key **326** and private key **328** include or correspond to keys generated by server **310** (e.g., processor **312**) based on master key **324**, and may be part of a public/private key pair. Digital signatures **330** may include digital signatures generated based on data components **317** and private key **328**, as further described herein. Secure data structure **332** includes or corresponds to a secure data structure that is immutable to other devices and is configured for serial addition of entries. To illustrate, each subsequent entry of secure data structure **332** may be based at least in part on a previous entry of

secure data structure **332**. In some implementations, secure data structure **332** includes or corresponds to a private blockchain. Alternatively, secure data structure **332** may include or correspond to a tree structure, or the tree structure may be stored in the private blockchain, as further described herein. Secure data structure **332** may be configured to store digital signatures **330** for transmission to other devices, such as node device **360**. In some implementations, secure data structure **332** stores a first digital signature **334** and a second digital signature **336**. In some other implementations, secure data structure **332** stores more than two digital signatures. Storage key **338** includes or corresponds to a cryptographic key used by server **310** to encrypt data for transmission to other devices. In some implementations, storage key **338** includes master key **324**. In some other implementations, storage key **338** is distinct from master key **324**, such as based on master key **324** or otherwise generated or received by server **310**. Additionally, memory **314** may include instructions (not shown) that are executable by processor **312** to cause processor **312** to perform one or more operations. In some implementations, the instructions may include or be arranged as an application, such as application **214** (e.g., a software program).

(60) Server **310** also includes multiple development stages **340**. The development stages are of a development process for software (e.g., **316**), and include development stages such as building, unit tests, integration tests, and assembly, as non-limiting examples. In some implementations, development stages **340** include a first development stage **342** and a second development stage **344**. In some other implementations, more than two development stages may be included in development stages **340**. In some implementations, development stages **340** correspond to a continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipeline for building and deploying the software release (e.g., software **316**). Performance of the development stages **340** may cause generation of stage data **319**. For example, performance of first development stage **342** may cause generation of first stage data **320**, and performance of second development stage **344** may cause generation of second stage data **322**. Additionally, or alternatively, some of digital signatures **330** (e.g., digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332**) may correspond to development stages **340**. For example, first digital signature **334** may correspond to first development stage **342**, and second digital signature **336** may correspond to second development stage **344**. As another example, first digital signature **334** may correspond to head data **318** and second digital signature **336** may correspond to first development stage **342**.

(61) Although system **300** is described as including one server **310**, in other implementations, system **300** may include multiple servers (e.g., **310**) coupled to node device **360**. Additionally, or alternatively, it is noted that server **310** (e.g., processor **312**) may include one or more additional components or modules, such as manager **252**, deployer **253**, replicator **254**, tracker **256**, analyzer **258**, and/or indexer **260**, as illustrative, non-limiting examples.

(62) Node device **360** includes one or more processors **362**, a memory **364** (e.g., one or more memories), and a transaction directory **370**. Transaction directory **370** may include or correspond to a storage device configured to receive and store one or more files. In some implementations, transaction directory **370** is distinct from memory **364**. In other implementations, transaction directory **370** includes a logical or virtual portion of memory **364**.

(63) Memory **364** may include instructions (not shown) that are executable by processor **362** to cause processor **362** to perform one or more operations. In some implementations, the instructions may include or be arranged as an application, such as application **294** (e.g., a software program). Additionally, or alternatively, memory **364** may include one or more files (e.g., software), such as software corresponding to a release bundle.

(64) Processor **362** includes a validator **363**. Validator **363** is configured to verify whether software (e.g., one or more files) has successfully completed one or more of the multiple development stages of development stages **340**. For example, validator **363** may verify that one or more files have successfully completed an initial development stage, an intermediate development stage, a final development stage, or multiple development stages, a portion of the development process, or an

entirety of the development process. Additionally, or alternatively, validator **363** may validate that received data components are accurate, and that the one or more files and the data components have not been altered after completion of at least a portion of the development process. In some implementations, validator **363** includes a validator module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., the processor **172** of FIG. **1** or processor **362**) to verify whether software has successfully completed at least a portion of the development process and validate whether the received data components are accurate.

(65) Although system **300** is described as including one node device **360**, in other implementations, system **300** may include multiple node devices (e.g., **360**) coupled to server **310**. Additionally, or alternatively, it is noted that node device **360** (e.g., processor **362**) may include one or more additional components or modules, such as manager **252** and/or replicator **254**, as illustrative, non-limiting examples.

(66) During operation of system **300**, server **310** performs the development process that includes development stages **340** on software **316** (e.g., one or more files). Successful initiation of the development process causes head data **318** to be generated, and successful completion of a development stage causes corresponding stage data of stage data **319** to be generated. For example, successful completion of first development stage **342** causes generation of first stage data **320**. As another example, successful completion of second development stage **344** causes generation of second stage data **322**. Head data **318** may include general development parameters associated with the development process (e.g., the pipeline run), such as configuration (“config”) data at the time of initiation, a development process version number, an initiation time (e.g., a timestamp), an identifier (e.g., name) associated with the development process, a run number associated with the development process, details of a git command associated with the development process, or a combination thereof. In some implementations, the config data may include full pipeline yaml configuration data output as a string. Stage data corresponding to a particular development stage includes inputs to the particular development stage (e.g., outputs of a previous development stage), configuration data associated with or generated during the particular development stage (e.g., action flags, locations in a file system of actions or files to be acted on, registry names, document image names, and the like), outputs of the particular development stage (e.g., inputs to a subsequent development stage), information associated with the particular development stage (e.g., author(s) or trigger condition(s), start time, end time, build job number, and the like), additional data, or a combination thereof. For example, first stage data **320** may include configuration data associated with first development stage **342**, one or more inputs to first development stage **342**, one or more outputs from first development stage **342**, a start time for first development stage **342**, an end time for first development stage **342**, one or more authors associated with first development stage **342**, one or more trigger conditions of first development stage **342**, a build job number associated with performance of first development stage **342**, other information associated with first development stage **342**, or any combination thereof. In some implementations, first development stage **342** corresponds to a unit test, and second development stage **344** corresponds to an integration test. In other implementations, first development stage **342** and second development stage **344** correspond to other development stages. Additionally or alternatively, completion of all of development stages **340** may cause generation of completed development information **323**. Completed development information **323** may include a completion time (e.g., a timestamp) and run component information, which in some implementations includes an order list of hashes of head data **318** and all of stage data **319**. In some implementations, any of head data **318**, stage data **319**, or completed development information **323** that include inputs and outputs that are artifacts may be saved as references to a corresponding hash and an original path at server **310**. For example, an input may include BuildInfo and child PipeInfo, which may be saved as references to the corresponding hash and the original path for BuildInfo at server **310**. In some implementations, data components **317** may each be stored as a string (e.g., a concatenation of all information associated with the data

component in a string), which may be saved as a file such as a JSON file.

(67) To use in generation of digital signatures, server **310** generates public key **326** and private key **328**. Public key **326** and private key **328** may be included in a public/private key pair that is generated by server **310**. For example, server **310** may generate the public/private key pair based on master key **324**. In some implementations, private key **328**, public key **326**, or both, may include or correspond to Gnu Privacy Guard (GPG) keys or other types of encryption keys. To further illustrate, private key **328** (and corresponding public key **326**) may be a “run key” that is generated within the CI/CD pipeline performing the development process that includes development stages **340**, using master key **324** as a certificate (e.g., to sign private key **328** and public key **326**). In some implementations, master key **324** includes or corresponds to a private and secure key that is maintained by server **310** and stored at memory **314** as part of supporting a universal artifact repository at server **310**. Server **310** may generate and store public key **326** and private key **328** at memory **314** for use in generating digital signatures and for transmission to other devices.

(68) Upon completion of a data component of the data components **317**, server **310** generates a corresponding digital signature of digital signatures **330** using the corresponding data component and private key **328**. For example, upon successful completion of head data **318**, server **310** generates first digital signature **334** based at least in part on head data **318** and private key **328**. As another example, upon successful completion of first development stage **342**, server **310** generates second digital signature **336** based at least in part on first stage data **320** and private key **328**. As another example, upon success completion of all of development stages **340**, server **310** generates a final digital signature based on completed development information **323** and private key **328**. As yet another example, a digital signature may be generated when an initial development stage is completed, a digital signature may be generated when an intermediate development stage is completed, and a digital signature may be generated when a final development stage is completed. In some implementations, at least one development stage can have two or more digital signatures (e.g., there may be different digital signatures for when different sets of files complete the same development stage). In some implementations, each digital signature may correspond to a software build job, such as a software build job of a CI/CD pipeline. For example, each digital signature of digital signatures **330** may represent successful completion by a software build job of a corresponding development stage (or the portion of the development process that corresponds to the data component). Each digital signature of digital signatures **330** may correspond to a respective one or more files (e.g., artifacts) or to an entirety of software **316** (e.g., one or more files). Additionally, or alternatively, regardless of the process used to generate digital signatures **330**, each of digital signature of digital signatures **330** may be reproducible at another device, such as node device **360**, using the corresponding data component and a key, such as public key **326**, as further described herein.

(69) In some implementations, server **310** generates digital signatures **330** using the corresponding data component (e.g., either an entirety or portion thereof). To illustrate, server **310** may “stringify” or otherwise package the corresponding data component, such as by serially ordering the corresponding data component and converting the ordered data component to a string, and server **310** may sign (e.g., encrypt) the string (or otherwise packaged) version of the corresponding data component using private key **328** to generate a corresponding digital signature. For example, server **310** may generate first digital signature **334** by signing a string (or other data type) corresponding to an entirety (or a portion) of head data **318** using private key **328**. As another example, server **310** may generate second digital signature **336** by signing a string (or other data type) corresponding to an entirety (or a portion) of first stage data **320** using private key **328**. In some implementations, server **310** generates a digital signature for each data component, including an initial component, each development stage of development stages **340**, and completion of development stages **340**, based on a corresponding data component and private key **328**.

(70) In some other implementations, server **310** generates digital signatures **330** using a value that

is based on the corresponding data component (e.g., either an entirety or portion thereof). To illustrate, server **310** may generate a hash value (or other value) based on the corresponding data component, and server **310** may sign (e.g., encrypt) the hash value (or other value) using private key **328** to generate a corresponding digital signature. For example, server **310** may generate a first hash value based on an entirety (or a portion) of head data **318**, and server **310** may generate first digital signature **334** by signing the first hash value using private key **328**. As another example, server **310** may generate a second hash value based on an entirety (or portion) of first stage data **320**, and server **310** may generate second digital signature **336** by signing the second hash value using private key **328**. Any type of hash function or other one-way mapping function may be used, such as a Merkle-Damgård 5 (MD5) function, a secure hash algorithm 1 (SHA-1) function, a SHA-2 function, a RACE integrity primitives evaluation message digest (RIPEMD) function, an advanced encryption standard (AES) function, a SHA-3 function, a BLAKE2 function, or a BLAKE3 function, as non-limiting examples. In some implementations, server **310** generates a digital signature for each development stage of development stages **340** based on a hash value (or other value) based on stage data corresponding to the respective development stage and private key **328**, in addition to digital signatures based on head data **318** and completed development information **323**. Generating digital signatures **330** based on hash values (or other values) that are based on data components **317** may reduce the memory footprint associated with digital signatures **330**.

(71) After generating digital signatures **330**, server **310** may store one or more digital signatures of digital signatures **330** in secure data structure **332**. Secure data structure **332** may be configured to store one or more digital signatures and to be immutable to other devices. For example, entries, such as digital signatures, in secure data structure **332** are not retroactively alterable without subsequent alteration of all subsequent entries, which may require private key **328** (which is not accessible to other devices). In some implementations, secure data structure **332** may include or correspond to a private blockchain that is maintained by server **310** (e.g., a blockchain that is not distributed amongst multiple devices). Additionally, or alternatively, secure data structure **332** may be configured for serial addition of entries. To illustrate, each subsequent entry of secure data structure **332** may be based at least in part on the previous entry within secure data structure **332**. For example, a subsequent entry in secure data structure **332** may include a cryptographic hash, or other information, that is based on a previous entry in secure data structure **332** and that links the subsequent entry to the previous entry. In some implementations, secure data structure **332** may include or correspond to a tree structure. For example, secure data structure **332** may be maintained as a tree, such as a binary using last odd leaf duplication (for trees with an odd number of leaves) or a Merkle mountain range (MMR) tree, as non-limiting examples. An MMR tree is a binary tree where each parent node is the concatenated hash of the two child nodes.

(72) Server **310** may be configured to store digital signatures **330** in respective entries of secure data structure **332**. For example, server **310** may add a first entry that includes first digital signature **334** to secure data structure **332**. As another example, server **310** may add a second entry that includes second digital signature **336** and that is based at least in part on the first entry to secure data structure **332**. To further illustrate, the second entry (that includes second digital signature **336**) may include a cryptographic hash value, or other value, that is based on the first entry (that includes first digital signature **334**). In some implementations, each entry in secure data structure **332** may include a digital signature for a respective data component and at least a portion of the data component. For example, the first entry of secure data structure **332** may include first digital signature **334** and at least a portion of head data **318**. As another example, the second entry of secure data structure **332** may include second digital signature **336**, a hash value based on the first entry, and at least a portion of first stage data **320**. Additionally or alternatively, one or more entries in secure data structure **332** may be based on previous entries. To illustrate, in an example in which secure data structure **332** implements (or stores) a MMR tree, the first entry may correspond to

head data **318**, the second entry may correspond to first stage data **320**, and another entry may be added that is a concatenation of a hash of the first entry and a hash of the second entry.

(73) In some implementations, server **310** may discard private key **328** based on addition of a final entry to secure data structure **332**. To illustrate, upon completion of all of development stages **340** (e.g., an entirety of the development process) and storage of digital signatures **330** as entries in secure data structure **332**, server **310** (e.g., processor **312**) may discard private key **328**. Discarding private key **328** may include deleting private key **328** from memory **314** or altering or otherwise marking private key **328** as unusable. Discarding private key **328** after completion of storing entries in secure data structure **332** may prevent any other device from being capable of altering entries within, or adding entries to, secure data structure **332**, which may transition secure data structure **332** from being “append only” to “read only.” For example, prior to deletion of private key **328**, entries may be appended to secure data structure **332** by server **310** using private key **328**, and after deletion, secure data structure **332** is no longer modifiable and can only be read.

(74) After completing development stages **340**, generating digital signatures **330**, and adding entries to secure data structure **332**, server **310** may generate a software release **350**. Software release **350** may include software **316** (e.g., one or more files) and software release information that includes validation information **352**. Validation information includes data components **317**, and optionally public key **326** and secure data structure **332**. Server **310** transmits software release **350** to node device **360** based on node device **360** being indicated in node information associated with software **316** (e.g., a list of node devices to which software **316** is to be distributed). Server **310** also transmits software release **350** to other node devices indicated by the node information. Although described as transmitting software release **350** to node device **360**, in some other implementations, server **310** may provide a portion, or an entirety, of software release **350** to node device **360** in other manners. For example, server **310** may store secure data structure **332** in a public database that is accessible to node device **360** (and any other device indicated by the node information), and public key **326** may be distributed with validation information **352** or in separate messaging. Additionally or alternatively, instead of being transmitted to node device **360**, validation information **352** may be stored in the database that stores secure data structure **332**, and node device **360** may retrieve validation information **352** from the database.

(75) In some implementations, prior to transmission of software release **350**, server **310** encrypts secure data structure **332** based on storage key **338**. Storage key **338** may be accessible to other devices, such as node device **360**. In some implementations, storage key **338** includes or corresponds to master key **324**. In some other implementations, storage key **338** is a different encryption key that is transmitted along with software release **350** to node device **360**, or is otherwise accessible to node device **360**. In some implementations, although secure data structure **332** is encrypted, public key **326** and stage data **319** are not encrypted. In some other implementations, all of validation information **352** (e.g., secure data structure **332**, public key **326**, and stage data **319**) are encrypted based on storage key **338** prior to transmission to node device **360**.

(76) After receiving software release **350** from server **310**, node device **360** identifies the one or more files indicated by the software release information. In some implementations, node device **360** receives software **316** from server **310** and stores software **316** in transaction directory **370**. Alternatively, node device **360** may retrieve software **316** and validation information **352** from a public database or other storage location. In some implementations, node device **360** may already store at least one of the one or more files, and the one or more files may be transferred to transaction directory **370** as software **316**.

(77) After identifying (and/or receiving) software **316**, node device **360** may perform one or more validation operations on software **316** and/or on validation information **352**. For example, validator **363** verifies whether software **316** has completed at least a portion of the development process that includes development stages **340** based on validation information **352**. To illustrate, node device

360 may validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332** to determine whether software **316** successfully completed at least a portion of the development process. Additionally, or alternatively, node device **360** may validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332** to determine whether data components **317** are accurate and/or whether software **316** or data components **317** have been altered after completion of the portion of the development process. Node device **360** (e.g., validator **363**) may validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332** by generating validation signatures **366** based on data components **317** and public key **326**, and comparing each validation signature to the corresponding digital signature.

(78) To illustrate, validator **363** may generate validation signatures **366** by signing each piece of stage data **319** using public key **326**, similar to how server **310** generates digital signatures **330** using private key **328**. In some implementations, validation signatures **366** include at least a first validation signature **367** and a second validation signature **368**. For example, validator **363** may generate first validation signature **367** based on head data **318** and public key **326**. As another example, validator **363** may generate second validation signature **368** based on first stage data **320** (e.g., associated with first development stage **342**) and public key **326**. Thus, each validation signature of validation signatures **366** may be generated based on a corresponding data component and public key **326**. In some implementations, validator **363** may generate one or more validation signatures **366** based on an entirety (or a portion) of the corresponding data component. For example, validator **363** may stringify or otherwise package head data **318** (or a portion thereof) to generate first validation signature **367**. In some other implementations, validator **363** may generate validation signatures **366** based on a hash value, or other value, based on the corresponding stage data. For example, validator **363** may generate a first hash value based on head data **318**, and validator **363** may generate first validation signature **367** based on the first hash value and public key **326**.

(79) After generating validation signatures **366**, node device **360** (e.g., validator **363**) compares validation signatures **366** to the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332** to validate data components **317** and/or software **316**. To illustrate, validator **363** may compare a validation signature associated with a particular data component to a digital signature stored in secure data structure **332** that is associated with the particular data component to perform the validation. For example, validator **363** may compare first validation signature **367** to first digital signature **334** stored in secure data structure **332**. As another example, validator **363** may compare second validation signature **368** to second digital signature **336** stored in secure data structure **332**. Because validation signatures **366** are generated in the same manner as digital signatures **330**, if a validation signature matches a corresponding digital signature, node device **360** may verify that software **316** completed the associated development stage (or portion or entirety of the development process) and validate the associated data component (e.g., verify that the associated data component is accurate). For example, validator **363** may validate first digital signature **334** and head data **318** based on first validation signature **367** matching first digital signature **334**. Validating first digital signature **334** and/or head data **318** verifies that software **316** successfully completed initiation of the development process. As another example, validator **363** may validate second digital signature **336** and first stage data **320** based on second validation signature **368** matching second digital signature **336**. Validating second digital signature **336** and/or first stage data **320** verifies that software **316** successfully completed first development stage **342**. It will be noted that, although public key **326** enables generation of one or more validation signatures, public key **326** cannot be used to add or modify entries in secure data structure **332**. Thus, in at least some implementations, data components **317** and public key **326** may be transmitted without encryption, because if a malicious actor alters data components **317** or public key **326**, validation will fail at recipient devices (e.g., node device **360**).

(80) In some implementations, at least a portion of validation information **352** is encrypted by server **310**. In such implementations, node device **360** (e.g., validator **363**) may decrypt the

encrypted portion of validation information **352** based on storage key **338**. For example, if secure data structure **332** is encrypted when received (or retrieved from a public database), validator **363** may decrypt secure data structure **332** based on storage key **338**. In some implementations, node device **360** may receive storage key **338** from server **310**, such as in addition to or as part of software release **350**. In some other implementations, server **310** and node device **360** may each generate copies of the same storage key (e.g., storage key **338**) based on instructions or other shared information.

(81) Node device **360** processes software **316** based on verifying that software **316** (e.g., the one or more files) has completed development stages **340** and that data components **317** are accurate. For example, if validator **363** performs successful validation, node device **360** may load software **316** to memory **364** (or another memory other than transaction directory **370**). Additionally, node device **360** may set validation flag **369** to indicate that software **316** has successfully completed development stages **340** (e.g., the development process) and that data components **317** are accurate. Processing software **316** may also include executing software **316** at node device **360**. In some implementations, software **316** may be executed based on at least a portion of data components **317**, such as head data **318**, stage data **319**, completed development information **323**, or a combination thereof. Node device **360** may also transmit a notification to server **310**, the notification indicating that software **316** is accepted. Alternatively, if validator **363** fails validation, node device **360** may discard (e.g., delete) software **316** from transaction directory **370** and transmit a notification to server **310**, the notification indicating that software **316** is rejected. Additionally, node device **360** may clear validation flag **369**. In some implementations, the notification may identify which digital signature is not validated, which development stage or data component corresponds to the non-validated digital signature, an author that corresponds to the non-validated digital signature, or a combination thereof.

(82) In some implementations, node device **360** may display a user interface (UI) that displays information associated with the development process. For example, the UI may include a button or other selectable indicator to enable validation of the development process, and validation information **352** may be shared, and secure data structure **332** updated, based on input to the UI. As validation may be time consuming and resource intensive, providing an option to validate the development process may reduce demand on server **310** when validation is not requested. When validation is requested, data components **317** or completed development information **323** may be displayed in addition to a “last validated time.” Additionally or alternatively, any of stage data **319** may be displayed (e.g., based on a particular request or as part of the display at the UI based on the request for validation). Although described as being performed by node device **360**, in some implementations, display of the UI for validation purposes may be performed at server **310**.

(83) According to one aspect, a system for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The system includes at least one memory (e.g., **314**) storing instructions and one or more processors (e.g., **312**) coupled to the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to cause the one or more processors to obtain one or more files (e.g., **316**) associated with the software release (e.g., **350**) based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., **340**). Performance of at least a portion of the development process generates data components (e.g., **317**) associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The one or more processors are also configured to generate a private key (e.g., **328**) and a public key (e.g., **326**) based on a master key (e.g., **324**) accessible to the one or more processors. The one or more processors are configured to, for each of the data components, generate a digital signature (e.g., **330**) based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key, and add an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure (e.g., **332**) accessible to one or more node devices (e.g., **360**). The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure.

The one or more processors are further configured to initiate transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices.

(84) According to another aspect, a computer program product is described that includes a computer-readable storage device, such as a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, that includes instructions that, when executed by one or more processors (e.g., 312), cause the one or more processors to perform operations for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages. The operations include executing a first routine to obtain one or more files (e.g., 316) associated with the software release (e.g., 350) based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., 340). Performance of at least the portion of the development process generates data components (e.g., 317) associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The operations also include executing a second routine to generate a private key (e.g., 328) and a public key (e.g., 326) based on a master key (e.g., 324) accessible to the one or more processors. The operations include executing a third routine to, for each of the data components, generate a digital signature (e.g., 330) based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key, and add an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure (e.g., 332) accessible to one or more node devices (e.g., 360). The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. The operations further include executing a fourth routine to initiate transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices.

(85) According to another aspect, a system for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The system includes at least one memory (e.g., 364) storing instructions and one or more processors (e.g., 362) coupled to the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to cause the one or more processors to receive one or more files (e.g., 316) of the deployed software release (e.g., 350) and validation information (e.g., 352) including data components (e.g., 317) associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., 340). The one or more processors are also configured to access a secure data structure (e.g., 332) and a public key (e.g., 326) associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures (e.g., 330) associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key (e.g., 328) used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The one or more processors are also configured to, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure to validate the one or more digital signatures, generate a validation signature (e.g., 366) based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key, and compare the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The one or more processors are further configured to process the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

(86) According to another aspect, a computer program product is described that includes a computer-readable storage device, such as a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, that includes instructions that, when executed by one or more processors (e.g., 362), cause the one or more processors to perform operations for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages. The operations include executing a first routine to receive one or more files (e.g., 316) of the deployed software release (e.g., 350) and validation information (e.g., 352) including data components (e.g., 317) associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., 340). The operations also include executing a second routine to access a secure data structure (e.g., 332) and a public key (e.g., 326) associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures (e.g., 330) associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key (e.g., 328) used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The operations also include executing a third routine to, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure to

validate the one or more digital signatures, generate a validation signature (e.g., **366**) based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key, and compare the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The operations further include executing a fourth routine to process the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

(87) Thus, system **300** describes generation and/or use of a secure data structure that stores digital signatures to verify whether software **316** has completed at least a portion of a development process, such as at least one of development stages **340**, and validate whether data components **317** are accurate. For example, secure data structure **332** (storing one or more digital signatures), data components **317**, and public key **326** may be included in software release **350** that is transmitted to node device **360** (or retrieved from a database accessible to node device **360**). Data components **317** and public key **326** may advantageously be used by node device **360** to validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332**, which verifies whether software **316** has successfully completed at least a portion of the development process and validates that data components **317** are accurate. Thus, node device **360** may refrain from processing software that has not completed at least a portion of the development process and/or using inaccurate (or altered) data components **317**, which may prevent node device **360** from being exposed to vulnerabilities corresponding to software that is not fully developed and tested (e.g., has not successfully completed the development stages **340**). This may also prevent insertion of unauthorized code into software **316** after completion of the development process (or a development stage thereof).

(88) Referring to FIG. 4, a block diagram of a system for sharing validation information of a software release according to one or more aspects is shown and designated **400**. System **400** may include or correspond to at least a portion of system **100** and/or system **200**. System **400** includes an entity device **410**, a server **440**, and a node device **470**. Entity device **410**, server **440** and node device **470** may be coupled via one or more networks, such as network **120**. Entity device **410** may include or correspond to entity server **140**, entity **150**, **150a**, **150b**, or any combination thereof. Server **440** may include or correspond to server **110**, server **168**, or a combination thereof. Node device **470** may include or correspond to node device **160**, **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, or **160d**.

(89) Entity device **410** includes one or more processors **412** and a memory **414**. Memory **414** includes software **416** (e.g., one or more files) and data components **417**. Data components **417** may include head data **418**, stage data **419**, completed development information **422**, other data, or a combination thereof. Head data **418** may include general development parameters associated with the development process (e.g., the pipeline run), such as configuration data at the time of initiation, a development process version number, an initiation time (e.g., a timestamp), an identifier (e.g., name) associated with the development process, a run number associated with the development process, details of a git command associated with the development process, or a combination thereof. In some implementations, the config data may include full pipeline yaml configuration data output as a string. Stage data **419** includes data generated during performance of one or more development stages of a development process for a software release, such as configuration data associated with the development stage, one or more inputs to the development stage, one or more outputs from the development stage, a start time for the development stage, an end time for the development stage, one or more authors associated with the development stage, one or more trigger conditions associated with the development stage, or any combination thereof. In some implementations, stage data **419** includes first stage data **420** and second stage data **421**. In some other implementations, more than two stage data may be included in stage data **419**. Completed development information **422** may include a completion time and references to each of the other data components/run components, such as an ordered list of hashes of head data **418** and stage data **419**. Additionally, memory **414** may include instructions (not shown) that are executable by processor **412** to cause processor **412** to perform one or more operations. In some implementations, the instructions may include or be arranged as an application, such as application **284** (e.g., a

software program) of FIG. 2, associated with server **440**.

(90) Entity device **410** also includes or performs a development process that includes multiple development stages **424**. The development stages are of a development process for software and include development stages such as building, unit tests, integration tests, and assembly, as non-limiting examples. In some implementations, development stages **424** include a first development stage **426** and a second development stage **428**. In some other implementations, more than two development stages may be included in development stages **424**. In some implementations, development stages **424** correspond to a CI/CD pipeline for building and deploying a software release. Performance of the development stages **424** may cause generation of stage data **419**. For example, performance of first development stage **426** may cause generation of first stage data **420**, and performance of second development stage **428** may cause generation of second stage data **421**. Additionally or alternatively, initiation of the development process may cause generation of head data **418**, and completion of the development process may cause generation of completed development information **422**. Although system **400** is described as including one entity device **410**, in some other implementations, system **400** may include multiple entity devices (e.g., **410**) coupled to server **440**.

(91) Server **440** includes one or more processors **442** and a memory **444**. Memory **444** may include or correspond to memory **210** of FIG. 2. Memory **444** includes software **446** (e.g., one or more files/artifacts), a master key **448**, a public key **450**, a private key **452**, digital signatures **454**, a secure data structure **456**, and optionally a storage key **459**. Software **446** may include or correspond to software **116** and may include one or more of artifacts **114** and/or artifacts **218**. Master key **448** may include or correspond to a cryptographic key associated with a universal artifact repository or software release deployment supported by server **440**. Public key **450** and private key **452** include or correspond to keys generated by server **440** (e.g., processor **442**) based on master key **448**, and may be part of a public/private key pair. Digital signatures **454** may include digital signatures generated based on data components **417** and private key **452**, as further described herein. Secure data structure **456** includes or corresponds to a secure data structure that is immutable to other devices and is configured for serial addition of entries. To illustrate, each subsequent entry of secure data structure **456** may be based at least in part on a previous entry of secure data structure **456**. In some implementations, secure data structure **456** includes or corresponds to a private blockchain. Additionally or alternatively, secure data structure **456** may include or be implemented as a tree structure, such as an MMR tree as a non-limiting example. Secure data structure **456** may be configured to store digital signatures **454** for transmission to other devices, such as node device **470**. In some implementations, secure data structure **456** stores a first digital signature **457** and a second digital signature **458**. In some other implementations, secure data structure **456** stores more than two digital signatures. Storage key **459** includes or corresponds to a cryptographic key used by server **440** to encrypt data for transmission to other devices. In some implementations, storage key **459** includes master key **448**. In some other implementations, storage key **459** is distinct from master key **448**, such as based on master key **448** or otherwise generated or received by server **440**. Additionally, memory **444** may include instructions (not shown) that are executable by processor **442** to cause processor **442** to perform one or more operations. In some implementations, the instructions may include or be arranged as an application, such as application **214** (e.g., a software program) of FIG. 2.

(92) Although system **400** is described as including one server **440**, in other implementations, system **400** may include multiple servers (e.g., **440**) coupled to entity device **410** and/or node device **470**. Additionally, or alternatively, it is noted that server **440** (e.g., processor **442**) may include one or more additional components or modules, such as manager **252**, deployer **253**, replicator **254**, tracker **256**, analyzer **258**, and/or indexer **260**, as illustrative, non-limiting examples.

(93) Node device **470** includes one or more processors **472**, a memory **474** (e.g., one or more memories), and a transaction directory **480**. Transaction directory **480** may include or correspond to

a storage device configured to receive and store one or more files. In some implementations, transaction directory **480** is distinct from memory **474**. In other implementations, transaction directory **480** includes a logical or virtual portion of memory **474**.

(94) Memory **474** may include instructions (not shown) that are executable by processor **472** to cause processor **472** to perform one or more operations. In some implementations, the instructions may include or be arranged as an application, such as application **294** (e.g., a software program) of FIG. 2. Additionally, or alternatively, memory **474** may include one or more files (e.g., software), such as software corresponding to a release bundle.

(95) Processor **472** includes a validator **473**. Validator **473** is configured to verify whether software (e.g., one or more files) has successfully completed at least a portion of the development processes, such as one or more of the multiple development stages of development stages **424**. For example, validator **473** may verify that one or more files have successfully completed an initial development stage, an intermediate development stage, a final development stage, or multiple development stages. Additionally, or alternatively, validator **473** may validate that received data components are accurate, and that the one or more files and the data components have not been altered after completion of the development stages **424** (or an entirety of the development process). In some implementations, validator **473** includes a validator module that includes one or more routines, executable by one or more processors (e.g., the processor **172** of FIG. 1 or processor **472**) to verify whether software has successfully completed at least a portion of the development process and validate whether the received data components are accurate.

(96) Although system **400** is described as including one node device **470**, in other implementations, system **400** may include multiple node devices (e.g., **470**) coupled to server **440**. Additionally, or alternatively, it is noted that node device **470** (e.g., processor **472**) may include one or more additional components or modules, such as manager **252** and/or replicator **254**, as illustrative, non-limiting examples.

(97) During operation of system **400**, entity device **410** performs at least a portion of a development process that includes development stages **424** on software **416** (e.g., one or more files). Successful completion of a corresponding portion of the development process causes a corresponding data component of data components **417** to be generated. For example, successful initiation of the development process causes generation of head data **418**. As another example, successful completion of first development stage **426** causes generation of first stage data **420**. Stage data corresponding to a particular development stage includes inputs to the particular development stage (e.g., outputs of a previous development stage), configuration (“config”) data associated with or generated during the particular development stage (e.g., action flags, locations in a file system of actions or files to be acted on, registry names, document image names, and the like), outputs of the particular development stage (e.g., inputs to a subsequent development stage), information associated with the particular development stage (e.g., author(s) or trigger condition(s), start time, end time, build job number, and the like), additional data, or a combination thereof. For example, first stage data **420** may include configuration data associated with first development stage **426**, one or more inputs to first development stage **426**, one or more outputs from first development stage **426**, a start time for first development stage **426**, an end time for first development stage **426**, one or more authors associated with first development stage **426**, one or more trigger conditions of first development stage **426**, a build job number associated with performance of first development stage **426**, other information associated with first development stage **426**, or any combination thereof. In some implementations, first development stage **426** corresponds to a unit test, and second development stage **428** corresponds to an integration test. In other implementations, first development stage **426** and second development stage **428** correspond to other development stages.

(98) Upon completion of development stages **424** (e.g., an entirety of the development process) to generate software **416** and data components **417**, entity device **410** may transmit software **416** and data components **417** to server **440**. In some implementations, server **440** receives software **416** and

data components **417** from entity device **410** and stores software **416** at memory **444** as software **446** (e.g., one or more files or artifacts). Alternatively, server **440** may receive an indication of the files included in software **416**, such as a list of the files, a checksum for each of the files, a checksum for an entirety of the files, or a combination thereof, and server **440** may identify files **446** (e.g., artifacts) stored at memory **444** that correspond to software **416**.

(99) In some implementations, entity device **410** also generates and/or provides node information **430**. Node information **430** includes an indication of one or more node devices, such as node device **470**, that software **416** is to be released to. In some implementations, node information **430** may indicate one or more distribution paths that are to be used to distribute software **416** to the one or more node devices. Server **440** receives node information **430** from entity device **410** and uses node information **430** to determine which node devices to send a software release to.

(100) After receiving software **416**, data components **417**, and optionally node information **430**, server **440** generates public key **450** and private key **452** to use in generating digital signatures. Public key **450** and private key **452** may be included in a public/private key pair that is generated by server **440**. For example, server **440** may generate the public/private key pair based on master key **448**. In some implementations, public key **450**, private key **452**, or both may include or correspond to GPG keys. To further illustrate, private key **452** (and corresponding public key **450**) may be a “run key” that is generated using master key **448** as a certificate (e.g., to sign private key **452** and public key **450**). In some implementations, master key **448** includes or corresponds to a private and secure key that is maintained by server **440** and stored at memory **444** as part of supporting a universal artifact repository at server **440**. Server **440** may generate and store public key **450** and private key **452** at memory **444** for use in generating digital signatures and for transmission to other devices.

(101) Server **440** generates digital signatures **454** to indicate successful completion of development stages **424** (or a portion thereof). To illustrate, server **440** may generate a corresponding digital signature of digital signatures **454** using the corresponding data component of data component **417** and private key **452**. For example, server **440** may generate first digital signature **457** based at least in part on head data **418** and private key **452**. As another example, server **440** may generate second digital signature **458** based at least in part on first stage data **420** and private key **452**. As another example, server **440** may generate a final digital signature based at least in part on completed development information **422** and private key **452**. As yet another example, a digital signature may be generated for completion of an initial development stage, a digital signature may be generated for completion of an intermediate development stage, and a digital signature may be generated for completion of a final development stage. Server **440** may generate digital signatures **454** when software **416** is received, when data components **417** are received, or at another time. For example, entity device **410** may provide corresponding data component(s) upon completion of a particular development stage of development stages **424**, and server **440** may generate a digital signature for the particular data component based on receiving the corresponding data component (e.g., based upon successful completion of the particular development stage that caused generation of the data component).

(102) In some implementations, at least one development stage can have two or more digital signatures (e.g., there may be different digital signatures for when different sets of files complete the same development stage). In some implementations, each digital signature may correspond to a software build job, such as a software build job of a CI/CD pipeline. For example, each digital signature of digital signatures **454** may represent successful completion by a software build job of a corresponding development stage or portion of the development process (e.g., receipt of a corresponding data component by server **440**, which indicates successful completion of the corresponding portion of the development process). Each digital signature of digital signatures **454** may correspond to a respective one or more files (e.g., artifacts) or to an entirety of software **446** (e.g., one or more files). Additionally, or alternatively, regardless of the process used to generate

digital signatures **454**, each of digital signature of digital signatures **454** may be reproducible at another device, such as node device **470**, using the corresponding data component and a key, such as public key **450**, as further described herein.

(103) In some implementations, server **440** generates digital signatures **454** using the corresponding data components (e.g., either an entirety or portion thereof). To illustrate, server **440** may stringify or otherwise package the corresponding data component, such as by serially ordering the corresponding data component and converting the ordered data component to a string, and server **440** may sign (e.g., encrypt) the string (or otherwise packaged) version of the corresponding data component using private key **452** to generate a corresponding digital signature. For example, server **440** may generate first digital signature **457** by signing a string (or other data type) corresponding to an entirety (or a portion) of head data **418** using private key **452**. As another example, server **440** may generate second digital signature **458** by signing a string (or other data type) corresponding to an entirety (or a portion) of first stage data **420** using private key **452**. In some implementations, server **440** generates a digital signature for each development stage of development stages **424** based on stage data corresponding to the respective development stage and private key **452**, in addition to digital signatures based on head data **418** and completed development information **422**.

(104) In some other implementations, server **440** generates digital signatures **454** using a value that is based on the corresponding data component (e.g., either an entirety or portion thereof). To illustrate, server **440** may generate a hash value (or other value) based on the corresponding data component, and server **440** may sign (e.g., encrypt) the hash value (or other value) using private key **452** to generate a corresponding digital signature. For example, server **440** may generate a first hash value based on an entirety (or a portion) of head data **418**, and server **440** may generate first digital signature **457** by signing the first hash value using private key **452**. As another example, server **440** may generate a second hash value based on an entirety (or portion) of first stage data **420**, and server **440** may generate second digital signature **458** by signing the second hash value using private key **452**. Any type of hash function or other one-way mapping function may be used, such as a MD5 function, a SHA-1 function, a SHA-2 function, a RIPEMD function, an AES function, a SHA-3 function, a BLAKE2 function, or a BLAKE3 function, as non-limiting examples. In some implementations, server **440** generates a digital signature for each data component of data components **417** based on a hash value (or other value) based on the respective data component and private key **452**. Generating digital signatures **454** based on hash values (or other values) that are based on data components **417** may reduce the memory footprint associated with digital signatures **454**.

(105) After generating digital signatures **454**, server **440** may store one or more digital signatures of digital signatures **454** in secure data structure **456**. Secure data structure **456** may be configured to store one or more digital signatures and to be immutable to other devices. For example, entries, such as digital signatures, in secure data structure **456** are not retroactively alterable without subsequent alteration of all subsequent entries, which may require private key **452** (which is not accessible to other devices). In some implementations, secure data structure **456** may include or correspond to a private blockchain that is maintained by server **440** (e.g., a blockchain that is not distributed amongst multiple devices). Additionally, or alternatively, secure data structure **456** may be configured for serial addition of entries. To illustrate, each subsequent entry of secure data structure **456** may be based at least in part on the previous entry within secure data structure **456**. For example, a subsequent entry in secure data structure **456** may include a cryptographic hash, or other information, that is based on a previous entry in secure data structure **456** and that links the subsequent entry to the previous entry. In some implementations, secure data structure **456** may include or correspond to a tree structure. For example, secure data structure **456** may be maintained as a tree, such as a binary using last odd leaf duplication (for trees with an odd number of leaves) or a MMR tree, as non-limiting examples.

(106) Server **440** may be configured to store digital signatures **454** in respective entries of secure

data structure **456**. For example, server **440** may add a first entry that includes first digital signature **457** to secure data structure **456**. As another example, server **440** may add a second entry that includes second digital signature **458** and that is based at least in part on the first entry to secure data structure **456**. To further illustrate, the second entry (that includes second digital signature **458**) may include a cryptographic hash value, or other value, that is based on the first entry (that includes first digital signature **457**). In some implementations, each entry in secure data structure **456** may include a digital signature for a respective development stage and at least a portion of the stage data associated with the respective development stage. For example, the first entry of secure data structure **456** may include first digital signature **457** and at least a portion of head data **418**. As another example, the second entry of secure data structure **456** may include second digital signature **458**, a hash value based on the first entry, and at least a portion of first stage data **420**.

(107) In some implementations, server **440** may discard private key **452** based on addition of a final entry to secure data structure **456**. To illustrate, upon storage of digital signatures **454** as entries in secure data structure **456**, server **440** (e.g., processor **442**) may discard private key **452**. Discarding private key **452** may include deleting private key **452** from memory **444** or altering or otherwise marking private key **452** as unusable. Discarding private key **452** after completion of storing entries in secure data structure **456** may prevent any other device from being capable of altering entries within, or adding entries to, secure data structure **456**, which may transition secure data structure **456** from append-only to read-only.

(108) After generating digital signatures **454** and adding entries to secure data structure **456**, server **440** may generate a software release **460**. Software release **460** may include software **446** (e.g., one or more files) and software release information that includes validation information **462**. Validation information **462** includes data components **417**, and optionally public key **450**, and secure data structure **456**. Server **440** transmits software release **460** to node device **470** based on node device **470** being indicated in node information **430**. Server **440** also transmits software release **460** to other node devices indicated by node information **430**. Although described as transmitting software release **460** to node device **470**, in some other implementations, server **440** may provide a portion, or an entirety, of software release **460** to node device **470** in other manners. For example, server **440** may store secure data structure **456**, data components **417**, or both in a public database that is accessible to node device **470** (and any other device indicated by node information **430**).

Additionally or alternatively, public key **450** may be provided to node device **470** via separate signaling, or with validation information **462**.

(109) In some implementations, prior to transmission of software release **460**, server **440** encrypts secure data structure **456** based on storage key **459**. Storage key **459** may be accessible to other devices, such as node device **470**. In some implementations, storage key **459** includes or corresponds to master key **448**. In some other implementations, storage key **459** is a different encryption key that is transmitted along with software release **460** to node device **470**, or is otherwise accessible to node device **470**. In some implementations, although secure data structure **456** is encrypted, public key **450** and data components **417** are not encrypted. In some other implementations, all of validation information **462** (e.g., secure data structure **456**, public key **450**, and data components **417**) is encrypted based on storage key **459** prior to transmission to node device **470**.

(110) Although server **440** is described as generating digital signatures **454** and managing secure data structure **456** and keys (e.g., public key **450**, private key **452**, etc.), in some other implementations, entity device **410** may generate digital signatures **454** and/or manage secure data structure **456** and the keys. For example, entity device **410** may access master key **448** to generate public key **450** and private key **452**, and entity device **410** may generate digital signatures **454** based on data components **417** and private key **452**. In some such implementations, entity device **410** may transmit data components **417**, digital signatures **454**, and public key **450** to server **440** for maintenance of secure data structure **456** and transmission of software release **460** to node device

470. In some other implementations, entity device **410** may maintain secure data structure **456**, such as storing entries in secure data structure **456** using private key **452**. In such implementations, entity device may transmit data components **417**, secure data structure **456**, and public key **450** to server **440** for use in transmission of software release **460**, or entity device **410** may transmit data components **417**, secure data structure **456**, and public key **450** directly to node device **470** (and any other node device indicated in node information **430**).

(111) After receiving software release **460** from server **440** (or entity device **410**), node device **470** identifies the one or more files indicated by the software release information. In some implementations, node device **470** receives software **446** from server **440** and stores software **446** in transaction directory **480**. Alternatively, node device **470** may retrieve software **446** and validation information **462** from a public database or other storage location. In some implementations, node device **470** may already store at least one of the one or more files, and the one or more files may be transferred to transaction directory **480** as software **446**.

(112) After identifying (and/or receiving) software **446**, node device **470** may perform one or more validation operations on software **446** and/or on validation information **462**. For example, validator **473** verifies whether software **446** has completed the development process (e.g., development stages **424**) based on validation information **462**. To illustrate, node device **470** may validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **456** to determine whether software **446** successfully completed the corresponding portion of the development process. Additionally, or alternatively, node device **470** may validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **456** to determine whether data components **417** are accurate and/or whether software **446** or data components **417** have been altered after completion of development stages **424**. Node device **470** (e.g., validator **473**) may validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **456** by generating validation signatures **476** based on data components **417** and public key **450**, and comparing each validation signature to the corresponding digital signature.

(113) To illustrate, validator **473** may generate validation signatures **476** by signing each of data components **417** using public key **450**, similar to how server **440** generates digital signatures **454** using private key **452**. In some implementations, validation signatures **476** include at least a first validation signature **477** and a second validation signature **478**. For example, validator **473** may generate first validation signature **477** based on head data **418** and public key **450**. As another example, validator **473** may generate second validation signature **478** based on first stage data **420** (e.g., associated with first development stage **426**) and public key **450**. Thus, each validation signature of validation signatures **476** may be generated based on a corresponding data component and public key **450**. In some implementations, validator **473** may generate one or more validation signatures **476** based on an entirety (or a portion) of the corresponding data component. For example, validator **473** may stringify or otherwise package head data **418** (or a portion thereof) to generate first validation signature **477**. In some other implementations, validator **473** may generate validation signatures **476** based on a hash value, or other value, based on the corresponding data component. For example, validator **473** may generate a first hash value based on head data **418**, and validator **473** may generate first validation signature **477** based on the first hash value and public key **450**.

(114) After generating validation signatures **476**, node device **470** (e.g., validator **473**) compares validation signatures **476** to the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **456** to validate data components **417** and/or software **446**. To illustrate, validator **473** may compare a validation signature associated with a particular data component to a digital signature stored in secure data structure **456** that is associated with the particular data component to perform the validation. For example, validator **473** may compare first validation signature **477** to first digital signature **457** stored in secure data structure **456**. As another example, validator **473** may compare second validation signature **478** to second digital signature **458** stored in secure data structure **456**. Because validation signatures **476** are generated in the same manner as digital signatures **454**, if a validation

signature matches a corresponding digital signature, node device **470** may verify that software **446** completed the associated development stage or portion of the development process and validate the associated data component (e.g., verify that the associated data component is accurate). For example, validator **473** may validate first digital signature **457** and head data **418** based on first validation signature **477** matching first digital signature **457**. Validating first digital signature **457** and/or head data **418** verifies that software **446** successfully completed initialization of the development process. As another example, validator **473** may validate second digital signature **458** and first stage data **420** based on second validation signature **478** matching second digital signature **458**. Validating second digital signature **458** and/or first stage data **420** verifies that software **446** successfully completed first development stage **426**. It will be noted that, although public key **450** enables generation of one or more validation signatures, public key **450** cannot be used to add or modify entries in secure data structure **456**. Thus, in at least some implementations, data components **417** and public key **450** may be transmitted without encryption, because if a malicious actor alters data components **417** or public key **450**, validation will fail at recipient devices (e.g., node device **470**).

(115) In some implementations, at least a portion of validation information **462** is encrypted by server **440**. In such implementations, node device **470** (e.g., validator **473**) may decrypt the encrypted portion of validation information **462** based on storage key **459**. For example, if secure data structure **456** is encrypted when received (or retrieved from a public database), validator **473** may decrypt secure data structure **456** based on storage key **459**. In some implementations, node device **470** may receive storage key **459** from server **440**, such as in addition to or as part of software release **460**. In some other implementations, server **440** and node device **470** may each generate copies of the same storage key (e.g., storage key **459**) based on instructions or other shared information.

(116) Node device **470** processes software **446** based on verifying that software **446** (e.g., the one or more files) has completed the development process (e.g., development stages **424**) and that data components **417** are accurate. For example, if validator **473** performs successful validation, node device **470** may load software **446** to memory **474** (or another memory other than transaction directory **480**). Additionally, node device **470** may set validation flag **479** to indicate that software **446** has successfully completed development stages **424** and that data components **417** are accurate. Processing software **446** may also include executing software **446** at node device **470**. In some implementations, software **446** may be executed based on at least a portion of data components **417**. Node device **470** may also transmit a notification to server **440**, the notification indicating that software **446** is accepted. Alternatively, if validator **473** fails validation, node device **470** may discard (e.g., delete) software **446** from transaction directory **480** and transmit a notification to server **440**, the notification indicating that software **446** is rejected. Additionally, node device **470** may clear validation flag **479**. In some implementations, the notification may identify which digital signature is not validated, which development stage corresponds to the non-validated digital signature, an author that corresponds to the non-validated digital signature, or a combination thereof. The notification may be sent from server **440** to entity device **410**.

(117) In some implementations, node device **470** may display a UI that displays information associated with the development process. For example, the UI may include a button or other selectable indicator to enable validation of the development process, and validation information **462** may be shared, and secure data structure **456** updated, based on input to the UI. As validation may be time consuming and resource intensive, providing an option to validate the development process may reduce demand on server **440** when validation is not requested. When validation is requested, data components **417** or completed development information **422** may be displayed in addition to a “last validated time.” Additionally or alternatively, any of stage data **419** may be displayed (e.g., based on a particular request or as part of the display at the UI based on the request for validation). Although described as being performed by node device **470**, in some implementations, display of

the UI for validation purposes may be performed at server **440**.

(118) According to one aspect, a system for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The system includes at least one memory (e.g., **444**) storing instructions and one or more processors (e.g., **442**) coupled to the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to cause the one or more processors to obtain one or more files (e.g., **446**) associated with the software release (e.g., **460**) based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., **424**). Performance of at least the portion of the development process generates data components (e.g., **417**) associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The one or more processors are also configured to generate a private key (e.g., **452**) and a public key (e.g., **450**) based on a master key (e.g., **448**) accessible to the one or more processors. The one or more processors are configured to, for each of the data components, generate a digital signature (e.g., **454**) based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key, and add an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure (e.g., **456**) accessible to one or more node devices (e.g., **470**). The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. The one or more processors are further configured to initiate transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices.

(119) According to another aspect, a computer program product is described that includes a computer-readable storage device, such as a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, that includes instructions that, when executed by one or more processors (e.g., **442**), cause the one or more processors to perform operations for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages. The operations include executing a first routine to obtain one or more files (e.g., **446**) associated with the software release (e.g., **460**) based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., **424**). Performance of at least the portion of the development process generates data components (e.g., **417**) associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The operations also include executing a second routine to generate a private key (e.g., **452**) and a public key (e.g., **450**) based on a master key (e.g., **448**) accessible to the one or more processors. The operations include executing a third routine to, for each of the data components, generate a digital signature (e.g., **454**) based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key, and add an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure (e.g., **456**) accessible to one or more node devices (e.g., **470**). The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. The operations further include executing a fourth routine to initiate transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices.

(120) According to another aspect, a system for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages is described. The system includes at least one memory (e.g., **474**) storing instructions and one or more processors (e.g., **472**) coupled to the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to cause the one or more processors to receive one or more files (e.g., **446**) of the deployed software release (e.g., **460**) and validation information (e.g., **462**) including data components (e.g., **417**) associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., **424**). The one or more processors are also configured to access a secure data structure (e.g., **456**) and a public key (e.g., **450**) associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures (e.g., **454**) associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key (e.g., **452**) used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The one or more processors are also configured to, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure to validate the one or more digital signatures, generate a validation signature (e.g., **476**) based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and

the public key, and compare the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The one or more processors are further configured to process the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

(121) According to another aspect, a computer program product is described that includes a computer-readable storage device, such as a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, that includes instructions that, when executed by one or more processors (e.g., **472**), cause the one or more processors to perform operations for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages. The operations include executing a first routine to receive one or more files (e.g., **446**) of the deployed software release (e.g., **460**) and validation information (e.g., **462**) including data components (e.g., **417**) associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages (e.g., **424**). The operations include executing a second routine to access a secure data structure (e.g., **456**) and a public key (e.g., **450**) associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures (e.g., **454**) associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key (e.g., **452**) used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The operations also include executing a third routine to, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure to validate the one or more digital signatures, generate a validation signature (e.g., **476**) based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key, and compare the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The operations further include executing a fourth routine to process the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

(122) Thus, system **400** describes generation and/or use of secure data structure **456** that stores digital signatures to verify whether software **446** has completed at least a portion of a development process (e.g., at least one of development stages **424**) and validate whether data components **417** are accurate. For example, secure data structure **456** (storing one or more digital signatures), data components **417**, and public key **450** may be included in software release **460** that is transmitted to node device **470** or made otherwise accessible to node device **470**. Data components **417** and public key **450** may advantageously be used by node device **470** to validate the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **456**, which verifies whether software **446** has successfully completed at least a portion of the development process (e.g., one or more of development stages **424**) and validates that data components **417** are accurate. Thus, node device **470** may refrain from processing software that has not completed one or more of development stages **424** and/or using inaccurate (or altered) data components **417**, which may prevent node device **470** from being exposed to vulnerabilities corresponding to software that is not fully developed and tested (e.g., has not successfully completed the development stages **424**). This may also prevent insertion of unauthorized code into software **446** after completion of a development stage.

(123) Referring to FIG. 5, a block diagram of an example of data components and a tree structure for validating a software release according to one or more aspects is shown and designated **500**. The data components may include or correspond to data components **317** of FIG. 3 or data components **417** of FIG. 4, and the tree structure may include or correspond to secure data structure **332** of FIG. 3 or secure data structure **456** of FIG. 4.

(124) Data components **502** may be generated during performance of a development process that includes multiple development stages, as described above with reference to FIGS. 1-4. In a particular implementation, the development process includes K stages, where K is any positive integer (at least three in the example of FIG. 5, though in other examples K is not so limited). In the example of FIG. 5, data components **502** include head data **504**, stage 1 data **506**, stage 2 data **508**, stage K data **510**, and completed development information **512**. Each of data components **502** are generated at particular times during the development process. For example, head data **504** may be generated after initiation of the development process, stage 1 data **506** may be generated after completion of a first development stage ("Stage 1"), stage 2 data **508** may be generated after

completion of a second development stage (“Stage 2”), stage K data **510** may be generated after completion of a Kth development stage (“Stage K”), and completed development information **512** may be generated after completion of all the K development stages of the development process. The information included in data components **502** is further described herein with reference to FIG. 7.

(125) As data components **502** are generated, each data component undergoes hashing and signing **520** to generate a digital signature (e.g., a signed version of a hash of the corresponding data component). To illustrate, hashing and signing **520** may cause generation of signed hash head **522** (corresponding to head data **504**), signed hash stage 1 **524** (corresponding to stage 1 data **506**), signed hash stage 2 **526** (corresponding to stage 2 data **508**), signed hash stage K **528** (corresponding to stage K data **510**), and signed hash information **530** (corresponding to completed development information **512**). Hashing and signing **520** may be performed with a private key associated with the development process, as described above with reference to FIGS. 3-4.

(126) Signed hashes **522-530** may be stored as nodes in a tree structure, which may be distributed across multiple devices or implemented (or stored in) a blockchain, as described above with reference to FIGS. 3-4. In some implementations, the tree structure may be an MMR tree that uses last odd leaf duplication, or another type of tree structure or secure data structure. After signed hashes **522-530** are stored as entries (e.g., nodes) in the tree structure, entries (e.g., nodes) of one or more other layers may be generated and stored in the tree structure. In the example of FIG. 5, each node of a subsequent layer (in the orientation shown in FIG. 5) is based on two child nodes of a preceding layer. For example, node N1 may store a hash of a concatenation of signed hash head **522** and signed hash stage 1 **524**, node N2 may store a hash of a concatenation of signed hash stage 2 **526** and a signed hash of other stage data, node N3 may store a hash of a concatenation of signed hash stage K **528** and signed hash information **530**, and node N4 may be a duplicated node (if the number of nodes in this layer is odd). To further illustrate, node N5 may store a hash of a concatenation of node N1 and node N2, node N6 may store a hash of a concatenation of node N3 and node N4, and node N7 may store a hash of a concatenation of node N5 and node N6. Use of a MMR tree (or a binary tree with last odd leaf duplication) enables predictability in validating the development process (or portions thereof) based on a position of a digital signature in a leaf chain of the tree structure. Additionally, the tree structure has a smaller memory footprint than storing the data components themselves, for example, it is expected that many software development processes will result in tens to hundreds of hash values, instead of the entirety of tens to hundreds of data components.

(127) The tree structure may be stored in a database accessible to node devices (or otherwise be provided to the node devices) to enable verification and validation of the software release and the data components at the node devices. In some implementations, the integrity of each data component (e.g., pipeline component or development stage) may be validated individually to validate the development process, or the development process (e.g., pipeline) as a whole may be validated without certifying component inclusion. To validate the integrity of a data component, a node device may calculate a hash of the data component (as received or as stored in the database), sign the hash using a public key associated with the development process, and validate that the signed hash generated by the node device is included in the tree structure. To validate the development process as a whole without certifying component inclusion, the node device may generate a hash of the completed development information **512**, sign the hash using the public key, and validate that the signed hash generated by the node device is included in the tree structure. Additionally or alternatively, to validate the development process as a whole, hierarchical information in the tree structure may be similarly validated, such as node N7 as a non-limiting example.

(128) Thus, FIG. 5 illustrates an example of a tree structure that may be used to store digital signatures generated based on data components generated during a development process of a software release. The tree structure may enable a node device that receives the software release to

verify that the software release has completed an entirety (or a portion) of the development process in a secure manner, which may prevent the node device from executing potentially compromised software.

(129) Referring to FIG. 6, a block diagram of an example of multiple development stages of a software release according to one or more aspects are shown and designated **600**. Multiple development stages **600** may include or correspond to development stages **340** of FIG. 3 or development stages **424** of FIG. 4.

(130) In the example of FIG. 6, multiple development stages **600** include code generation **610**, first build **612**, second build **614**, unity test **616**, unity test **618**, integration test **620**, integration test **622**, assembly **624**, additional testing **626**, distribution **628**, deployment **630**, and runtime **632**. In other implementations, fewer development stages or more development stages may be included. In the example of FIG. 6, code generation **610**, first build **612**, second build **614**, unity test **616**, unity test **618**, integration test **620**, integration test **622**, assembly **624**, additional testing **626**, and distribution **628** are performed at entity **602**, deployment **630** is performed at server **604**, and runtime **632** is performed at node **606**. Entity **602** may include or correspond to entity server **140**, entity **150**, **150a**, **150b**, entity device **410**, or any combination thereof. Server **604** may include or correspond to server **110**, server **168**, server **310**, server **440**, or any combination thereof. Node **606** may include or correspond to node device **160**, **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**, node device **360**, node device **470**, or any combination thereof.

(131) To start the development process, code may be generated at code generation **610**. For example, code for one or more files (e.g., artifacts) may be generated or developed. The code may be combined into a first build job at first build **612**. The first build job may undergo unity testing at unity test **616**. During performance and/or upon successful completion of unity test **616**, first stage data is generated. The first stage data may indicate one or more inputs of unity test **616**, configuration data associated with unity test **616**, one or more outputs of unity test **616**, a start time of unity test **616**, an end time of unity test **616**, an author of unity test **616**, one or more triggering conditions of unity test **616**, other information, or any combination thereof. The first stage data may be provided to server **604** for storage and eventual transmission to node **606**, similar to as described with reference to FIGS. 3-4. After completion of unity test **616**, the first build job may undergo integration test **620**. Second stage data may be generated during performance and/or upon completion of integration test **620**, similar to the first stage data. After completion of integration test **620**, the first build job may undergo additional tests or other development stages, which may generate corresponding stage data.

(132) In addition to generating the first build job, the code may be combined into a second build job at second build **614**. Although two builds are shown in FIG. 6, in other implementations, the code may undergo a single build or more than two builds. Also, although described as different build jobs, the first build job and the second build job may be different portions of the same build job. The second build job may undergo unity testing at unity test **618**. During performance and/or upon successful completion of unity test **618**, third stage data is generated. The third stage data may be provided to server **604** for storage and eventual transmission to node **606**. After completion of unity test **618**, second build job may undergo integration test **622**. Fourth stage data may be generated during performance and/or upon completion of integration test **622**, similar to the third stage data. After completion of integration test **622**, the second build job may undergo additional tests or other development stages, which may generate corresponding stage data.

(133) The first build job and the second build job (e.g., the first portion and the second portion) may be combined at assembly **624**. Upon successful completion of assembly **624**, stage data for assembly **624** may be generated. The stage data for assembly **624** may be provided to server **604** for storage and eventual transmission to node **606**. After completion of assembly **624**, the build may undergo additional testing **626**. Additional stage data may be generated during performance and/or upon completion of additional testing **626**, similar to as described for assembly **624**. After

completion of the additional testing **626**, the build job may undergo one or more other testing stages or development stages prior to distribution **628**.

(134) At distribution **628**, the software corresponding to the build job (e.g., the one or more files of the software release) is provided to server **604** for deployment. Server **604** may deploy the software release at **630**, including transmitting the software release (and validation information, such as a secure data structure storing one or more digital signatures, the stage data, and a public key) to one or more node devices, including node **606**. At runtime **632**, the software release undergoes validation **634**. For example, a validator (e.g., **363**) may verify that the software release has successfully completed one or more of development stages **610-528** based on the digital signatures stored in the secure data structure, the stage data (e.g., of development stages **610-528**), and a public key, as described with reference to FIGS. **3-4**. For example, node **606** may generate and compare validation signatures to the digital signatures stored in the secure data structure to validate the digital signatures and the stage data before processing the software release.

(135) Thus, FIG. **6** illustrates an example of generation of stage data during development stages of a software release. The stage data, in combination with other data components (e.g., head data, completed development information, etc.) can be used by a node device to enable the node device to verify completion of a development process that includes the development stages for a software release and to validate received digital signatures and received data components, such as stage data, prior to processing the software release, which may prevent the node device from being exposed to vulnerabilities of software that is not fully developed or tested or software that has been altered by a malicious actor after completion of the development process.

(136) Referring to FIG. **7**, an example of data components used to generate digital signatures for validating a software release according to one or more aspects is shown. The data components include stage data **700**, head data **730**, and completed development information **750**. In some implementations, stage data **700** may include or correspond to stage data **319** of FIG. **3** or stage data **419** of FIG. **4**, head data **730** may include or correspond to head data **318** of FIG. **3** or head data **418** of FIG. **4**, and completed development information **750** may include or correspond to completed development information **323** of FIG. **3** or completed development information **422** of FIG. **4**.

(137) Stage data **700** includes a development stage identifier **702**, one or more inputs including a first input **704** ("Input_1"), a second input **706** ("Input_2"), and an mth input **708** ("Input_M"), configuration data **710**, one or more outputs including a first output **712** ("Output_1"), a second output **714** ("Output_2"), an nth output **716** ("Output_N"), a start timestamp **720**, an end timestamp **722**, one or more author identifiers **724**, one or more triggering conditions **726**, and pass/fail indicator **728**. Although FIG. **7** illustrates stage data **700** as including each of the elements **702-728**, in some other implementations, one or more of **702-728** are optional or are not included in stage data **700**.

(138) Development stage identifier **702** may indicate a development stage of a development process for a software release, the development stage associated with stage data **700**. For example, stage data **700** may be generated during performance and/or upon completion of the development stage indicated by development stage identifier **702**. Inputs **704-708** indicate variables, constants, and/or other inputs to the development stage associated with stage data **700**. Configuration data **710** includes or indicates one or more action flags associated with performance of the development stage associated with stage data **700**, locations in a file system of actions or files to be acted on during performance of the development stage, registry names associated with performance of the development stage, document image names of documents to be accessed, created, or modified during performance of the development stage, and the like. Outputs **712-716** indicate variables, constants, and or other outputs from the development stage associated with stage data **700**. Start timestamp **720** indicates a time when the development stage associated with stage data **700** is started. End timestamp **722** indicates a time when the development stage associated with stage data

700 is complete. Author identifiers **724** include identifier(s) of one or more authors (e.g., one or more users that initiated performance of the development stage associated with stage data **700**). Trigger conditions **726** indicate one or more conditions that triggered performance of the development stage associated with stage data **700**. Pass/fail indicator **728** (e.g., a result flag, a particular bit, etc.) has a first value if the software release passed the development stage and a second value if the software release failed the development stage.

(139) Head data **730** includes general information and/or parameters associated with the development process (e.g., a pipeline) of the software release, such as a version number **732**, an initiation time **734**, a name **736**, a run number **738**, git details **740**, and configuration data **742**. Although FIG. 7 illustrates head data **730** as including each of the elements **732-742**, in some other implementations, one or more of **732-742** are optional or are not included in head data **730**. Version number **732** may indicate a version of the development process (e.g., a pipeline version). Initiation time **734** may be a timestamp that is recorded at a time of initiation of the development process. Name **736** may indicate a name (e.g., a pipe name) or other identifier that identifies the development process. Run number **738** may indicate a particular run of the development process (e.g., a number of the performance of the development process). Git details **740** may indicate details of a git command associated with the development process (e.g., pipe git details). Configuration data **742** may indicate a full config at initiation of the development process, such as a full pipeline yaml configuration. In some implementations, configuration data **742** may be converted from to a string format.

(140) Completed development information **750** includes a completion time **752** and an ordered list of hashes **754** corresponding to the run components (e.g., head data **730** and multiple instances of stage data **700**) generated during performance of the development process. Although FIG. 7 illustrates completed development information **750** as including each of the elements **752-754**, in some other implementations, one or more of **752-754** are optional or are not included in completed development information **750**. Completion time **752** may be a timestamp that is recorded at a time of completion of the development process (e.g., completion of the last development stage). Ordered list of hashes **754** may include multiple hashes of other data components, in a particular order (e.g., an order of generation or a predefined order, as non-limiting examples). In the example of FIG. 7, ordered list of hashes **754** includes head data hash **756**, stage data 1 hash **758**, and stage data K hash **760**, where head data hash **756** is a first entry in the list, stage data 1 hash **758** is a second entry in the list, and stage data K hash **760** is a last entry in the list. Head data hash **756** is a hash (e.g., a SHA-256 hash, as a non-limiting example) of head data **730**, stage data 1 hash **758** is a hash of stage data from a first development stage, and stage data K hash **760** is a hash of stage data from a Kth development stage (e.g., a last development stage of the development process).

(141) Thus, FIG. 7 illustrates an example of data components, such as stage data **700**, head data **730**, and completed development information **750**. The data components may be used to generate digital signatures or validation signatures, to enable node devices to validate received data components associated with software verify that the received software has completed a development process.

(142) FIGS. **8-9** are flow diagrams of methods of sharing validation information and validating a deployed software release according to one or more aspects. Each of the methods of FIGS. **8-9** may be stored in a computer-readable storage medium as instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform the operations of the method of FIG. **8** or FIG. **9**.

(143) Referring to FIG. **8**, a flow diagram of a method for sharing validation information of a software release associated with multiple development stages according to one or more aspects is shown as a method **800**. In some implementations, method **800** may be performed by server **110**, **168** (e.g., one or more processors **250**, manager **252**, and/or deployer **253**), server **310** (e.g., one or more processors **312**), and/or server **440** (e.g., one or more processors **442**).

(144) At **802**, method **800** includes obtaining one or more files associated with the software release based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages. Performance of at least the portion of the development process may generate data components associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. For example, server **310** may generate software **316** based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes development stages **340**. Performance of at least the portion of the development process may generate data components **317**. As another example, server **440** may receive software **416** and data components **417** from entity device **410**.

(145) At **804**, method **800** includes generating a private key and a public key based on a master key accessible to one or more processors. For example, server **310** may generate public key **326** and private key **328** (e.g., a public key/private key pair) based on master key **324**.

(146) At **806**, method **800** includes, for each of the data components, generating a digital signature based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key. For example, server **310** may generate digital signatures **330** based on data components **317** and private key **328**.

(147) At **808**, method **800** includes, for each of the data components, adding an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure accessible to one or more node devices. The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. For example, server **310** may add a second entry including second digital signature **336** to secure data structure **332** based on a first entry that includes first digital signature **334**. In some implementations, the secure data structure is immutable to other devices (e.g., node devices or other endpoint devices). In some implementations, the secure data structure includes or corresponds to a private blockchain or a tree structure, or is configured to store a tree structure, as non-limiting examples.

(148) At **810**, method **800** includes initiating transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to one or more node devices. For example, server **310** may transmit software release **350** to node device **360**. Software release **350** includes software **316** (e.g., one or more files) and validation information **352** that includes data components **317**, and optionally public key **326** and secure data structure **332**. Alternatively, secure data structure **332** may be accessible to node device **360**, such as by being stored in a database.

(149) In some implementations, generating a digital signature for a first data component of the data components may include generating the digital signature based on an entirety of the first data component and the private key. For example, server **310** may generate first digital signature **334** based on an entirety (or a portion thereof) of head data **318** and private key **328**. Alternatively, generating a digital signature for a first data component of the data components may include generating a hash value based on the first data component and generating the digital signature based on the hash value and the private key. For example, server **310** may generate a first hash value based on head data **318** and may generate first digital signature **334** based on the first hash value and private key **328**.

(150) In some implementations, method **800** also includes discarding the private key based on addition of a final entry to the secure data structure. The final entry corresponds to a final data component associated with the development process. For example, server **310** may discard private key **328** based on addition of a final (e.g., last) entry to secure data structure **332**. Additionally or alternatively, method **800** may further include, prior to access of the secure data structure to the one or more node devices, encrypting the secure data structure based on a storage key accessible to the one or more processors and the one or more node devices. For example, server **310** may encrypt secure data structure **332** based on storage key **338**. In some such implementations, the storage key includes the master key. For example, storage key **338** may include or correspond to master key **324**, or may be based on master key **324**.

(151) In some implementations, generating the digital signature and adding the entry for each of the data components includes generating a first digital signature based at least in part on first stage data

associated with a first development stage of the multiple development stages and the private key, adding a first entry that includes the first digital signature to the secure data structure, generating a second digital signature based at least in part on second stage data associated with a second development stage of the multiple development stages that is subsequent to the first development stage and the private key, and adding a second entry that includes the second digital signature and is based at least in part on the first entry to the secure data structure. For example, server **310** may add a first entry to secure data structure **332** that includes first digital signature **334**, and server **310** may add a second entry to secure data structure **332** that includes second digital signature **336** and is based at least in part on the first entry in secure data structure **332** (e.g., includes a hash value based on the first entry).

(152) In some implementations, obtaining the one or more files may include performing at least the portion of the development process to generate the one or more files. For example, server **310** (e.g., processor **312**) may initiate the development process and/or perform development stages **340** to generate software **316** (e.g., one or more files) and data components **317**. Alternatively, obtaining the one or more files may include receiving the one or more files from one or more entity devices that perform at least the portion of the development process. For example, server **440** may receive software **416** (e.g., one or more files) and data components **417** from entity device **410** that performs the development process that includes development stages **424**.

(153) Thus, method **800** describes a method for sharing validation information for a software release between a server and a node device. Providing the validation information to the node device enables the node device to validate whether software has successfully completed multiple development stages of a development process without alteration, which may prevent the node device from processing software that is not fully developed or tested, or that has been altered by a malicious actor.

(154) Referring FIG. **9**, a flow diagram of a method for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages according to one or more aspects of the disclosure is shown as a method **900**. In some implementations, method **900** may be performed by node device **160**, **160a**, **160b**, **160c**, **160d**, node device **360**, and/or node device **470**.

(155) At **902**, method **900** includes receiving one or more files of the deployed software release and validation information including data components associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages. For example, node device **360** may receive validation information **352** (e.g., data components **317**) from server **310**.

(156) At **904**, method **900** includes accessing a secure data structure and a public key associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key used to generate the one or more digital signatures. For example, node device **360** may access secure data structure **332** and public key **326**. Secure data structure **332** may store one or more of digital signatures **330**, and public key **326** may be associated with private key **328** used by server **310** to generate digital signatures **330**. In some implementations, the one or more files, the stage data, and the public key are received from an artifact repository server or an entity device. For example, node device **360** of FIG. **3** may receive validation information **352** from server **310** (e.g., an artifact repository server), and node device **470** of FIG. **4** may receive validation information **462** from server **440** (e.g., an artifact repository server) or from entity device **410**.

(157) At **906**, method **900** includes validating the one or more digital signatures by, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure, generating a validation signature based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key. For example, node device **360** may generate validation signatures **366** based on data components **317** and public key **326**.

(158) At **908**, method **900** includes validating the one or more digital signatures by, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure, comparing the validation

signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. For example, node device **360** may compare validation signatures **366** to corresponding ones of digital signatures **330** stored in secure data structure **332** to validate the digital signatures.

(159) At **910**, method **900** includes processing the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures. For example, node device **360** may process software **316** based on successful validation of the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332** (which verifies that software **316** successfully completed the development process including development stages **340**).

(160) In some implementations, validating a first digital signature of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure may include generating a first validation signature based at least in part on a first data component corresponding to the first digital signature and the public key, comparing the first validation signature to the first digital signature, and validating the first digital signature based on the first validation signature matching the first digital signature. For example, node device **360** may generate first validation signature **367** based at least in part on head data **318** and public key **326**. Node device **360** may compare first validation signature **367** to first digital signature **334** and may validate first digital signature **334** based on first validation signature **367** matching first digital signature **334**. Additionally or alternatively, method **900** may further include decrypting the secure data structure based on a storage key accessible to the one or more processors. For example, node device **360** may decrypt secure data structure **332** (or any encrypted portion of validation information **352**) based on storage key **338**.

(161) In some implementations, generating a validation signature for a first data component of the data components may include generating the validation signature based on an entirety of the first data component and the public key. For example, node device **360** may generate first validation signature **367** based on an entirety (or a portion thereof) of head data **318** and public key **326**. Alternatively, generating a validation signature for a first data component of the data components may include generating a hash value based on the first data component and generating the validation signature based on the hash value and the public key. For example, node device **360** may generate a first hash value based on head data **318**, and node device **360** may generate first validation signature **367** based on the first hash value and public key **326**.

(162) In some implementations, processing the one or more files may include loading the one or more files to a memory responsive to validating the one or more digital signatures and setting a flag corresponding to the one or more files to indicate that the one or more files have completed the multiple development stages. For example, node device **360** may load software **316** to memory **364** and set validation flag **369** based on validation of the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332**. In some such implementations, processing the one or more files may further include executing the one or more files and initiating transmission of a notification indicating that the one or more files are accepted. For example, node device **360** may execute software **316** and transmit a notification to server **310**, the notification indicating that software **316** is accepted. Additionally, or alternatively, processing the one or more files may include discarding the one or more files responsive to responsive to a failure to validate the one or more digital signatures. For example, node device **360** may discard software **316** from transaction directory **370** based on failure of validation of the digital signatures stored in secure data structure **332**. In some such implementations, processing the one or more files may further include initiating transmission of a notification indicating that the one or more files are rejected. For example, node device **360** may transmit a notification to server **310**, the notification indicating that software **316** is rejected, and optionally information associated with any non-validated digital signatures, such as development stages associated with the digital signatures, authors associated with the digital signatures, other information, or a combination thereof.

(163) Thus, method **900** describes a method for using validation information, such as data components, a public key, and a secure data structure that stores digital signatures, at a node device to validate whether software has successfully completed multiple development stages of a

development process without alteration. Validation of software may prevent the node device from processing software that is not fully developed or tested, thereby preventing the node device from being exposed to vulnerabilities corresponding to the not fully developed or otherwise altered software.

(164) In some implementations, methods **800** and/or **900** can be combined such that one or more operations described with reference to one of the methods of FIGS. **8-9** may be combined with one or more operations of another of FIGS. **8-9**. For example, one or more operations of method **800** may be combined with one or more operations of method **900**. As another example, one or more operations of method **900** may be combined with one or more operations of method **800**.

(165) In some aspects, techniques for supporting sharing of validation information of a software release may include additional aspects, such as any single aspect or any combination of aspects described below or in connection with one or more other processes or devices described elsewhere herein. In some aspects, supporting sharing of validation information of a software release may include a system configured to obtain one or more files associated with the software release based on performance of at least a portion of a development process that includes the multiple development stages. Performance of at least the portion of the development process generates data components associated with general development parameters, one or more development stages of the multiple development stages, or a combination thereof. The system is also configured to generate a private key and a public key based on a master key accessible to the system. The system is configured to, for each of the data components, generate a digital signature based at least in part on the respective data component and the private key and add an entry that includes the digital signature to a secure data structure accessible to one or more node devices. The entry is added based on a previous entry in the secure data structure. The system is further configured to initiate transmission of the data components, the public key, and the one or more files to the one or more node devices. In some implementations, the system includes one or more devices, one or more processors, one or more package modules, or a combination thereof. For example, one or more operations described with reference to the system may be performed by the one or more devices, the one or more processors, the one or more package modules, or the combination thereof. In some implementations, the system may include at least one processor, and a memory coupled to the at least one processor. The at least one processor may be configured to perform operations described herein with respect to the system. In some other implementations, the system may include a non-transitory computer-readable medium having program code recorded thereon and the program code may be executable by a computer for causing the computer to perform operations described herein with reference to the system. In some implementations, the system may include one or more means configured to perform operations described herein. In some implementations, a method of a repository supporting multiple package types may include one or more operations described herein with reference to the system.

(166) In a first aspect, the secure data structure is immutable to other devices.

(167) In a second aspect, alone or in combination with the first aspect, the secure data structure includes a private blockchain.

(168) In a third aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through second aspects, the secure data structure includes a tree structure.

(169) In a fourth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through third aspects, generating a digital signature for a first data component of the data components includes generating the digital signature based on an entirety of the first data component and the private key.

(170) In a fifth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through third aspects, generating a digital signature for a first data component of the data components includes generating a hash value based on the first data component and generating the digital signature based on the hash value and the private key.

(171) In a sixth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through fifth aspects,

the system discards the private key based on addition of a final entry to the secure data structure. The final entry corresponds to a final data component associated with the development process. (172) In a seventh aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through sixth aspects, the system, prior to access of the secure data structure to the one or more node devices, encrypts the secure data structure based on a storage key accessible to the system and the one or more node devices.

(173) In an eighth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through seventh aspects, generating the digital signature and adding the entry for each of the data components includes generating a first digital signature based at least in part on first stage data associated with a first development stage of the multiple development stages and the private key.

(174) In a ninth aspect, alone or in combination with the eighth aspect, generating the digital signature and adding the entry for each of the data components includes adding a first entry that includes the first digital signature to the secure data structure.

(175) In a tenth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the eighth through ninth aspects, generating the digital signature and adding the entry for each of the data components includes generating a second digital signature based at least in part on second stage data associated with a second development stage of the multiple development stages and the private key. The second development stage is subsequent to the first development stage.

(176) In an eleventh aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the eighth through tenth aspects, generating the digital signature and adding the entry for each of the data components includes adding a second entry that includes the second digital signature and is based at least in part on the first entry to the secure data structure.

(177) In a twelfth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through eleventh aspects, obtaining the one or more files includes performing at least the portion of the development process by the system to generate the one or more files.

(178) In a thirteenth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through eleventh aspects, obtaining the one or more files includes receiving the one or more files from one or more entity devices that perform at least the portion of the development process.

(179) In a fourteenth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through thirteenth aspects, the data components include head data, one or more stage data associated with the one or more development stages, completed development information, or any combination thereof.

(180) In a fifteenth aspect, in combination with the fourteenth aspect, the head data includes a version number associated with the development process, a start time for the development process, an identifier associated with the development process, a run number associated with the development process, a string of configuration details associated with the development process, or any combination thereof.

(181) In a sixteenth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the fourteenth through fifteenth aspects, stage data associated with a particular development stage of the multiple development stages includes configuration data associated with the particular development stage, one or more inputs to the particular development stage, one or more outputs from the particular development stage, a start time for the particular development stage, an end time for the particular development stage, one or more authors associated with the particular development stage, a result associated with the particular development stage, or any combination thereof.

(182) In a seventeenth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the fourteenth through sixteenth aspects, the completed development information includes a completion time for the development process, an ordered list of hashes of each other data component of the data components, or both.

(183) In an eighteenth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through seventeenth aspects, the secure data structure is configured for serial addition of entries. Each

subsequent entry of the secure data structure is based at least in part on a previous entry of the secure data structure.

(184) In a nineteenth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the first through eighteenth aspects, the multiple development stages correspond to a continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipeline for building and deploying the software release.

(185) In some aspects, techniques for supporting validation of a deployed software release may include additional aspects, such as any single aspect or any combination of aspects described below or in connection with one or more other processes or devices described elsewhere herein. In some aspects, supporting validation of a deployed software release may include a system configured to receive one or more files of the deployed software release and validation information including data components associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages. The system is also configured to access a secure data structure and a public key associated with the development process. The secure data structure includes one or more digital signatures associated with the data components. The public key is associated with a private key used to generate the one or more digital signatures. The system is also configured to validate the one or more digital signatures by, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure, generating a validation signature based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key, and comparing the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure. The system is further configured to process the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures. In some implementations, the system includes one or more devices, one or more processors, one or more package modules, or a combination thereof. For example, one or more operations described with reference to the system may be performed by the one or more devices, the one or more processors, the one or more package modules, or the combination thereof. In some implementations, the system may include at least one processor, and a memory coupled to the at least one processor. The at least one processor may be configured to perform operations described herein with respect to the system. In some other implementations, the system may include a non-transitory computer-readable medium having program code recorded thereon and the program code may be executable by a computer for causing the computer to perform operations described herein with reference to the system. In some implementations, the system may include one or more means configured to perform operations described herein. In some implementations, a method of a repository supporting multiple package types may include one or more operations described herein with reference to the system.

(186) In a twentieth aspect, validating a first digital signature of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure includes generating a first validation signature based at least in part on a first data component corresponding to the first digital signature and the public key, comparing the first validation signature to the first digital signature, and validating the first digital signature based on the first validation signature matching the first digital signature.

(187) In a twenty-first aspect, alone or in combination with the twentieth aspect, generating a validation signature for a first data component of the data components includes generating the validation signature based on an entirety of the first data component and the public key.

(188) In a twenty-second aspect, alone or in combination with the twentieth aspect, generating a validation signature for a first data component of the data components includes generating a hash value based on the first data component and generating the validation signature based on the hash value and the public key.

(189) In a twenty-third aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the twentieth through twenty-second aspects, processing the one or more files includes loading the one or more files to a memory responsive to validating the one or more digital signatures.

(190) In a twenty-fourth aspect, alone or in combination with the twenty-third aspect, processing the one or more files includes setting a flag corresponding to the one or more files to indicate that the one or more files have completed the multiple development stages.

(191) In a twenty-fifth aspect, in combination with one or more of the twenty-third through twenty-fourth aspects, processing the one or more files further includes executing the one or more files.

(192) In a twenty-sixth aspect, in combination with one or more of the twenty-third through twenty-fifth aspects, processing the one or more files further includes initiating transmission of a notification indicating that the one or more files are accepted.

(193) In a twenty-seventh aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the twentieth through twenty-sixth aspects, processing the one or more files includes discarding the one or more files responsive to responsive to a failure to validate the one or more digital signatures.

(194) In a twenty-eighth aspect, in combination with the twenty-seventh aspect, processing the one or more files further includes initiating transmission of a notification indicating that the one or more files are rejected.

(195) In a twenty-ninth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the twentieth through the twenty-eighth aspects, the data components include head data associated with general development parameters, stage data associated with the multiple development stages, and completed development information comprising an ordered list of hashes of the head data and the stage data.

(196) In a thirtieth aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the twentieth through twenty-ninth aspects, the one or more files and the validation information are received from an artifact repository server or an entity device.

(197) In a thirty-first aspect, alone or in combination with one or more of the twentieth through thirtieth aspects, the multiple development stages correspond to a continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipeline for building and deploying the software release.

(198) Although one or more of the disclosed figures may illustrate systems, apparatuses, methods, or a combination thereof, according to the teachings of the disclosure, the disclosure is not limited to these illustrated systems, apparatuses, methods, or a combination thereof. One or more functions or components of any of the disclosed figures as illustrated or described herein may be combined with one or more other portions of another function or component of the disclosed figures. Accordingly, no single implementation described herein should be construed as limiting and implementations of the disclosure may be suitably combined without departing from the teachings of the disclosure.

(199) The steps of a method or algorithm described in connection with the implementations disclosed herein may be included directly in hardware, in a software module executed by a processor, or in a combination of the two. A software module may reside in random access memory (RAM), flash memory, read-only memory (ROM), programmable read-only memory (PROM), erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), registers, hard disk, a removable disk, a compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), or any other form of non-transient (e.g., non-transitory) storage medium known in the art. An exemplary storage medium is coupled to the processor such that the processor can read information from, and write information to, the storage medium. In the alternative, the storage medium may be integral to the processor. The processor and the storage medium may reside in an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC). The ASIC may reside in a computing device or a user terminal. In the alternative, the processor and the storage medium may reside as discrete components in a computing device or user terminal.

(200) Although the present disclosure and its advantages have been described in detail, it should be understood that various changes, substitutions and alterations can be made herein without departing from the scope of the present disclosure as defined by the appended claims. Moreover, the scope of the present application is not intended to be limited to the particular embodiments of the process, machine, manufacture, composition of matter, means, methods and steps described in the specification. As one of ordinary skill in the art will readily appreciate from the present disclosure, processes, machines, manufacture, compositions of matter, means, methods, or steps, presently

existing or later to be developed that perform substantially the same function or achieve substantially the same result as the corresponding embodiments described herein may be utilized according to the present disclosure. Accordingly, the appended claims are intended to include within their scope such processes, machines, manufacture, compositions of matter, means, methods, or steps.

Claims

1. A method for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages, the method comprising: receiving, by one or more processors, one or more files of the deployed software release and validation information including data components associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages; accessing, by the one or more processors, a secure data structure and a public key associated with the development process, the secure data structure including one or more digital signatures associated with the data components, the public key associated with a private key used to generate the one or more digital signatures, where the private key and the public key are based on a master key that operates as a private cryptographic key for a universal artifact repository, and where the secure data structure is encrypted based on a storage key that is distinct from the private key and the public key; validating the one or more digital signatures by, for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure: generating, by the one or more processors, a validation signature based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key; and comparing, by the one or more processors, the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure; and processing, by the one or more processors, the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.
2. The method of claim 1, where validating a first digital signature of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure comprises: generating a first validation signature based at least in part on a first data component corresponding to the first digital signature and the public key; comparing the first validation signature to the first digital signature; and validating the first digital signature based on the first validation signature matching the first digital signature.
3. The method of claim 1, where generating a validation signature for a first data component of the data components comprises: generating the validation signature based on an entirety of the first data component and the public key.
4. The method of claim 1, where generating a validation signature for a first data component of the data components comprises: generating a hash value based on the first data component; and generating the validation signature based on the hash value and the public key.
5. The method of claim 1, where processing the one or more files comprises: loading, by the one or more processors, the one or more files to a memory responsive to validating the one or more digital signatures; and setting, by the one or more processors, a flag corresponding to the one or more files to indicate that the one or more files have completed the multiple development stages.
6. The method of claim 5, where processing the one or more files further comprises: executing, by the one or more processors, the one or more files; and initiating, by the one or more processors, transmission of a notification indicating that the one or more files are accepted.
7. The method of claim 1, where processing the one or more files comprises: discarding, by the one or more processors, the one or more files responsive to a failure to validate the one or more digital signatures.
8. The method of claim 7, where processing the one or more files further comprises: initiating, by the one or more processors, transmission of a notification indicating that the one or more files are rejected.
9. A system for validation of a deployed software release associated with multiple development stages, the system comprising: at least one memory storing instructions; and one or more processors

coupled to the at least one memory, the one or more processors configured to execute the instructions to cause the one or more processors to: receive one or more files of the deployed software release and validation information including data components associated with a development process that includes the multiple development stages; access a secure data structure and a public key associated with the development process, the secure data structure including one or more digital signatures associated with the data components, the public key associated with a private key used to generate the one or more digital signatures, where the private key and the public key are based on a master key that operates as a private cryptographic key for a universal artifact repository, and where the secure data structure is encrypted based on a storage key that is distinct from the private key and the public key; for each of the one or more digital signatures included in the secure data structure to validate the one or more digital signatures: generate a validation signature based at least in part on the data component corresponding to the digital signature and the public key; and compare the validation signature to the digital signature in the secure data structure; and process the one or more files based on validation of the one or more digital signatures.

10. The system of claim 9, where the one or more files and the validation information are received from an artifact repository server or an entity device.

11. The system of claim 9, where the multiple development stages correspond to a continuous integration/continuous delivery (CI/CD) pipeline for building and deploying the software release.

12. The system of claim 9, where the secure data structure comprises a private blockchain or a tree structure.

13. The system of claim 9, where the data components comprise head data associated with general development parameters, stage data associated with the multiple development stages, and completed development information.

14. The system of claim 13, where the head data comprises the general development parameters that are available at initiation of the development process.

15. The system of claim 13, where the head data comprises full configuration data that is available at initiation of the development process.

16. The system of claim 13, where first stage data comprises configuration data associated with a first development stage of the one or more development stages.

17. The system of claim 13, where first stage data comprises one or more inputs to a first development stage of the one or more development stages and one or more outputs from the first development stage.

18. The system of claim 13, where the completed development information comprises an ordered list of hashes of the head data and the stage data.
